The McNabb Family Archive

Family history and biographies, 1702 – 2025



Compiled by Paul Duke and Neeve McNabb

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Family Histories and Genealogical Research

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Edition 1.0 — October 17, 2026

Foreword

This project began simply enough. My mother, Beverly Nan McNabb, had accumulated a notebook of family records, and I decided to use the information to build a family tree. At the time, that was pretty much the extent of my ambition.

But one thing led to another. I wanted to preserve my grandmother's account of the family, and then there was the fascinating narrative about James Pinckney McNabb, which I thought deserved a wider audience. Before long, the family tree had grown into a website containing family histories, photographs, documents, and other material collected over generations.

Putting it all online seemed like the ideal solution. Anyone in the family could visit the website, explore the records, and learn something about the people who came before them. And it worked. But I gradually realized that websites have a peculiar disadvantage: people visit, enjoy what they find, and then go on with their lives. Links get misplaced, bookmarks forgotten, and the family history slips out of sight again.

My cousin Neeve was the first to suggest having the material in book form. I began considering the idea about a year ago, but life intervened, and the project sat unfinished until the fall of 2026.

By then, the significance of preserving these records had become even more apparent. With the passing of Warren Neil McNabb and his son Scott, the direct father-to-son line of this branch of the McNabb family had ended. The family continues through its daughters and their descendants, of course, but another chapter of our history had closed.

Neil also left us an extensive collection of poetry. His poems are sometimes humorous, sometimes reflective, and often deeply personal. They reveal a side of him that no genealogical record could capture. Some editions of this book include illustrations created long after the poems were written. These are interpretations of his words, not part of his original work, but I hope they add something to the experience of reading them.

This collection owes much to the family members who preserved these materials, especially my mother and Walter Craig Davidson, whose extensive research provided a foundation for much of what survives. It is not intended to be a complete or definitive family history. It is simply an effort to gather what we have, preserve it, and make it available to those who come after us.

Neeve hopes to give copies to her children for Christmas this year. I can think of no better reason to finally finish the book.

Paul Duke
October 2026

McNabb Family Tree

McNabb Family 1702–2025

Based primarily on Walter Craig Davidson's genealogical research, with recent generations contributed by family members.

- **William McNabb** (b.1702 *Glendochart, Scotland*) (d.1789 *Watauga Cty, Tenn - now North Carolina*) · **Betty Aiken** (b. *Glendochart, Perthshire, Scotland*) (d. *Scotland*)
  - **Baptist B. McNabb** (b.1723 *Glendochart, Perthshire, Scotland*) (d.1784 *Washington Cty, Tenn/NC*) · **Kathren** (b.1737 *Augusta Cty, Virginia*) (d.before.1784 *Washington Cty, Tenn/NC*)
    - **James Jonathan McNabb**
    - **Katrin McNabb**
    - **Margaret McNabb**
    - **Mary McNabb**
    - **William McNabb**
    - **David McNabb** (b.1755 *Augusta Cty, Virginia*) (d.1826 *Carter Cty, Tenn*) (m.1778) · **Elizabeth Taylor** (b.1757 *Augusta Cty, Virginia*) (d.1848 *Carter Cty, Tenn*)
      - **Absalom McNabb** (b.1779 *Washington Cty, Tenn/NC*) (d.1858 *Bakers Creek cemetery*) (m.1803) ♥ Mary Lusk (b.) (d.)
      - **Rhoda McNabb** (b.1780 *Washington Cty, Tenn/NC*) (d.) (m.1803)
      - **Nathaniel Taylor McNabb** (b.1783 *Washington Cty, Tenn/NC*) (d.1840 *Cleveland, Bradley Cty, Tenn*) (m.1805) · **Ellender McCubbins** (b.abt.1818 *Virginia*) (d.abt.1860 *Cleveland, Bradley Cty, Tenn*)
        - **Alfred W. McNabb** (b.1809 *Carter Cty, Tenn*) (d.abt.1858 *Bradley Cty, Tenn*) (m.1834) ♥ Susanah A. Ramsey (b.) (d.)
        - **James Pinckney McNabb** (b.1814 *Carter Cty, Tenn*) (d.1893 *Marshfield, Webster Cty, Missouri*) (m.1836) · **Easter Flanagan** (b.abt.1784 *Cherokee Indian Nation, Tenn*) (d.abt.1860)
          - **Albert Houston W. McNabb** (b.1837 *McMinn Cty, Tenn*) (d.1923 *Webster Cty, Missouri*) (m.1858) ♥ Mary J. Long (b.) (d.)
          - **Mathew McNabb** (b.1839 *Tennessee*) (d.1857 *Webster Cty, Missouri*)
          - **James M. McNabb** (b.1841 *Carter Cty, Tenn*) (d.) (m.1860 *Cooke Cty, Texas*) ♥ Eliza A. Chapman (b.) (d.)
          - **Theodore Washington McNabb** (b.1843 *Bradley Cty, Tenn*) (d.1926) (m.1868) ♥ Eliza Jane Kitchen (b.) (d.)
          - **Mary E. McNabb** (b.1846 *Carter Cty, Tenn*) (d.)
          - **Nathaniel Armstrong McNabb** (b.1848 *Carter Cty, Tenn*) (d.1900 *Ioni Creek Hmstd, Stephens Cty, Texas*) (m.1872 *Fannin Cty, Texas*) · **Rebecca Ann Turner** (b.1857 *Honey Grove, Fannin Cty, Texas*) (d.1936 *Ioni Creek Hmstd, Stephens Cty, Texas*)
            - **Walter Scott McNabb** (b.1874 *Desdemona, Eastland Cty, Texas*) (d.1936 *Amarillo, Potter Cty, Texas*) (m.1896 *Caddo, Stephens Cty, Texas*) · **Birtie Sophia McNeil** (b.1880) (d.1969)
              - **Warren Gilbert McNabb** (b.1898) (d.1975) (m.1930) · **Ruth Pauline Prutsman** (b.1906) (d.1997)
                - **Beverly Nan McNabb** (b.1932) (d.) · **Wylie Edgar Duke Jr.** (b.1930) (d.1992) (m.1952), **Harry Joseph Orr** (b.1931) (d.2007) (m.1965)
                  - **Wylie Paul Duke** (b.1953) (d.) (m.1990) ♥ Katharine H. Dewhurst (b.1957) (d.)
                  - **Ellen Lucille Duke** (b.1955) (d.) · **Michael Stuart Lazarus** (b.1948) (d.2011) (m.1987), **William Smith** (b.1955) (d.) (m.2011)
                    - **Jillian Lazarus** (b.1990) (d.) · **Anthony R. Torres** (b.1972) (d.)
                      - **Noah Torres** (b.2020) (d.)
                      - **Violet Audrey Torres** (b.2024) (d.)
                  - **Laurie Annette Duke** (b.1957) (d.)
                - **Warren Neil McNabb** (b.1934) (d.2025) (m.1952) · **Geraldine McCurry** (b.) (d.2023)
                  - **Scott McNabb** (b.1954) (d.2020) · **Sandy Prilliman** (b.) (d.)
                    - **Neala Aileen McNabb** (b.1979) (d.) · **Lopez** (b.) (d.)
                      - **Drake Lee James Lopez** (b.2002) (d.)
                      - **Layla Grace Kumara Sinha** (b.2007) (d.)
                      - **Dominic Dane Scott Flores** (b.2016) (d.)
                  - **Valerie McNabb** (b.1956) (d.2024) · **Randy Spencer** (b.) (d.)
                    - **Beth Spencer**
                    - **Daniel Spencer**
                  - **Neeve McNabb** (b.1964) (d.) · **Eric Forshee** (b.) (d.) (m.1982), **Edgar Armando Valenzuela** (b.1988) (d.) (m.2017)
                    - **Joel Eric Forshee** (b.1983) (d.)
                    - **Arika Neeve Forshee** (b.1985) (d.) (m.2014) · **Dustin Doyle Hall** (b.1983) (d.)

        - **Colter Scott Hall** (b.2008 *mother.Arika*) (d.)
        - **Stella Veda Hall** (b.2015) (d.)
        - **Sylas Eric Hall** (b.2017) (d.)
        - **Joshua Dustin Hall** (b.2018) (d.)
      - **Ashely Elise Forshee** (b.1988) (d.) (m.2017) · **Key Joseph Clark** (b.1977) (d.)
        - **Jade Lynn Clark** (b.2007 *step.child*) (d.)
        - **Koda Walter Clark** (b.2018) (d.)
        - **Enid Elise Clark** (b.2020) (d.)
      - **Jasmyn Elyssa Forshee** (b.1991) (d.)
    - **Viola Craig McNabb** (b.1900) (d.1996) · **Solomon Johnson Davidson** (b.) (d.) (m.1917), **Willam Whitson** (b.) (d.)
      - **Walter Craig Davidson** (b.1920) (d.)
      - **Ann Carol Davidson** (b.1922) (d.2020) · **James Paul Nagel** (b.1917) (d.2008)
        - **Paula Carol Nagel** (b.1942) (d.)
        - **James Craig Nagel** (b.1944) (d.)
  - **George R. McNabb** (b.1877 *Stephens Cty, Texas*) (d.1880 *Macedonia Cemetery, Texas*)
  - **James Pinckney II McNabb** (b.1880 *Stephens Cty, Texas*) (d.1967 *Quanah, Texas*) (m.1899) ♥ Augusta Fancher (b.) (d.)
  - **Lee McNabb** (b.1883 *Stephens Cty, Texas*) (d.)
  - **Jessie Franklin McNabb** (b.1886 *Stephens Cty, Texas*) (d.1970 *Macedonia Cemetery, Texas*)
  - **Ada McNabb** (b.1889 *Stephens Cty, Texas*) (d.1903)
  - **Myrtle E. McNabb** (b.1893 *Stephens Cty, Texas*) (d.1935) (m.1919) ♥ Charles Adams (b.) (d.)
  - **Clark McNabb** (b.1896 *Stephens Cty, Texas*) (d:unkn *Range, Eastland Cty, Texas*) ♥ Myrtle Smith (b.) (d.)
  - **Monti McNabb** (b.1897 *Stephens Cty, Texas*) (d.1906 *Macedonia Cemetery, Texas*)
- **William A. McNabb** (b.1850 *Bradley Cty, Tenn*) (d.1900 *Missouri*) ♥ Sarah Clementine Webb (b.) (d.)
- **Rebecca J. McNabb** (b.1852 *Webster Cty, Missouri*) (d.)
- **A.J. McNabb** (b.1853) (d.)
- **Harriet Ann McNabb** (b.1855 *Webster Cty, Mo.*) (d.abt.1905 *Webster Cty, Mo.*) (m.abt.1870) ♥ Franklin Minor (b.) (d.) Pastor
- **Lucretia McNabb** (b.1857 *Webster Cty, Mo.*) (d.) ♥ M. Hoff (b.) (d.)

- **Nathaniel T. McNabb** (b.1818 *Carter Cty, Tenn*) (d.1897) ♥ Serenia C. McInturff (b.) (d.) Lize Cath Walls (b.) (d.) Nancy Caroline Walls (b.) (d.)
- **Louisa McNabb** (b.1819 *Carter Cty, Tenn*) (d.) (m.1937) ♥ Francis M. Cooper (b.) (d.)
- **Lorena McNabb** (b.1823 *Carter Cty, Tenn*) (d.) (m.1841) ♥ Thomas Stanley (b.) (d.)
- **Armstrong McNabb** (b.1825 *Carter Cty, Tenn*) (d.) (m.1861) ♥ Naomi Henry (b.) (d.)
- **Fode McNabb** (b.1827 *Carter Cty, Tenn*) (d.)

- **Catherine McNabb** (b.1785 *Washington Cty, Tenn/NC*) (d.)
- **Jane McNabb** (b.1787 *Washington Cty, Tenn/NC*) (d.) (m.1809) ♥ John Brown (b.) (d.)
- **James McNabb** (b.1789 *Washington Cty, Tenn/NC*) (d.) (m.1814) ♥ Mary Wright (b.) (d.) Levesta Mynatt (b.) (d.)
- **David McNabb Jr.** (b.1791 *Washington Cty, Tenn/NC*) (d.) (m.1813) ♥ Margaret Whetson (b.) (d.)
- **Andrew Taylor McNabb** (b.1795 *Carter Cty, Tenn*) (d.) (m.1817) ♥ Margaret Bogart (b.) (d.)
- **William McNabb** (b.1796 *Carter Cty, Tenn*) (d.) (m.1830) ♥ Nancy Brown (b.) (d.)
- **Mathew Taylor McNabb** (b.1798 *Carter Cty, Tenn*) (d.)
- **Issac McNabb** (b.1800 *Carter Cty, Tenn*) (d.)
- **Alban McNabb** (b.1802 *Carter Cty, Tenn*) (d.after 1880)
- **Taylor McNabb** (b.1805 *Carter Cty, Tenn*) (d.1876 *McMinn Cty, Tenn*)

- **John McNabb** (b.1757) (d.)
- **Isabella McNabb** (b.1767) (d.) (m.1786 *Washington Cty, NC*) ♥ Andrew Taylor II (b.1733) (d.after 1780)

- **John McNabb**
- **Samuel McNabb**
- **Betty McNabb** (b.) (d.1809 *Rockbridge, Virginia*)
- **James McNabb**
- **David McNabb**
- **William McNabb**
- **Andrew McNabb**

James Pinckney McNabb



1814 – 1893

James Pinckney McNabb & Easter McNabb - Saga of the 1800's From Tennessee to Missouri to Texas back to Missouri Nathaniel Taylor McNabb & Ellender McCubbins McNabb's son, James Pinckney McNabb, b. Feb. 9, 1814 d. June 28, 1893, was born in Carter County, Tenn. and died in Marshfield, Webster County, Missouri. On Nov. 13, 1836 in Brailey City, Tenn. James P. married Easter Flanagan b. 1818 d. after the 1880 census. She was born on the Cherokee Indian Nation in Tennessee and was a full blood Cherokee. She died in Texas where she had gone from her home in Webster Cty. Missouri, after 1880, to tend to her sister who was ill. The family story is that she caught the same illness, died and was buried in Texas, at an unknown place because no one knows the sister's name, where she lived in Texas, or even the year that Easter traveled to Texas. However, James P. & Easter had a son, Nathaniel Armstrong McNabb b. April 2, 1848 d. March 26, 1900, who had moved within 3 miles of Macedonia Cemetery in 1876 & later, in 1900, was buried in the McNabb family plot in Macedonia Cemetery, Lascasas (could be two words) Community, Stephens Cty., Texas, on Ioni Creek, with space left vacant on one side for his wife, Rebecca Ann Turner b. Dec. 24, 1857 d. Jan. 29, 1942, but when Rebecca Ann passed away and the space beside Nathaniel A. McNabb was being excavated, it was discovered that some person in a coffin had already. been buried there so the grave was immediately reclosed. Thus, two things. First, Rebecca Ann McNabb, Nathaniel A's wife had to be buried serveral spaces away from her husband as children were earlier buried in the intervening spaces and second, it is surmised that when Easter died, Nathaniel Armstrong McNabb, her son, was notified and he arranged for his mother's burial in the family plot in Texas, instead of returning her for burial to Missouri. Inasmuch as Easter's burial could well have been 15-18 years prior to that of Nathaniel A. and 55 to 60 years prior to Rebecca Ann's burial, it is quite possible that no one remembered that Easter was buried in the family plot. Few even know why (in 1988) Nathaneil A. & Rebecca are not buried side by side.

Back to the beginning for James Pinckney & Easter McNabb. They had 11 children, 7 boys and 4 girls. They were Albert Houston 1837, Mathew 1839, James M. 1841, Theodore Washington 1843, Mary E. 1846, Nathaniel Armstrong 1848, William A. 1850, Rebecca J. 1852, A.J. 1853, Harriet Ann 1855, Lucretia 1857. James P. as a young man, moved from his birthplace in Carter Cty, Tennessee to the area that would become Bradley Cty Tenn. and thence to the Cherokee Indian Nation and back to Bradley Cty Tennessee all before November 1836 when he married Easter Flanagen. They lived variously from 1837 in McMinn Cty Tenn. to Carter Cty Tenn. to Bradley Cty Tenn. back to Carter Cty. Tenn., then in 1851 to Webster Cty., Missouri. They then moved to Fannin Cty Texas in 1858, to Cooke Cty. Texas in 1860, back to Fannin Cty. Texas, until the end of the Civil War, then back to Cooke Cty until 1867 when with the help of their eldest son Albert Houston McNabb who had come from Missouri to assist them, they returned to Webster Cty. Missouri. James P. had become blind in 1861-62 so remained in Webster Cty Missouri where he accumulated considerable land prior to his death, on June 28, 1893, which was an unusual and accidental circumstance, as follows. After becoming blind in 1861-62 James P. acquired a dog that went

everywhere with him & guided him around the many hazards to be found on his Missouri farm. On June 25, 1893 James P. had gone some distance from the house to cut & gather firewood. In the process he became injured but the dog assisted him sufficently for him to make it back to the house. Other family members placed the injured man on a pallet of quilts in the bed of a wagon. Apparently not enough care or skill was exercised and the wagon turned over on the way to Marshfield, Mo. & James P. was thrown from the wagon and died of his multiple injuries on June 28, 1893 & was buried in Timber Ridge Cemetery, Webster Cty, Missouri. Following is a Narrative dictated circa 1871-72 by James Pinckney McNabb to his daughter, Harriet Ann McNabb:

A SIMPLE NARRATIVE OF PLAIN FACTS

As related by James P. McNabb.

Reader, indulge an old man, sitting in the Evening of Life in Impentrable darkness, in recalling the unpretending incidents of a not uneventful life.

James P. McNabb, the subject of the following sketch, was the son of Nathaniel Taylor McNabb, and was born the ninth day of Feb. 1814. I was raised in the County of Carter, East Tennessee. My father and mother (Ellender McCubbins McNabb) were both invalids, and when I arrived at the age of 13 years, the support of my afflicted parents and family, mainly rested upon my young shoulders. There were nine children of us, 4 boys and 5 girls. When not laboring in home, or in some other profitable way for the family, I would obtain employment from home, yet near by, to get the money to pay for such articles as were really needed in a family, such as we could not manufacture ourselves. Thus my boyhood days were spent in labor and toil, and very few indeed were the hours of leisure.

When cold winter came on, my task was rendered doubly difficult, owing to a lack of even ordinary conveniences and means of performing it. I had to haul fuel on a one-horse sled a distance of half a mile or more, and often through snow from 6 to 8 inches in depth; and rails by the same conveyance through the sleet and storms of winter; a distance of a mile. The school boy at his comfortable desk and fireside, surrounded by joyous, happy companions mingling with him in a generous rivalry in the pursuit of knowledge and pleasure, knows little of the hardships that bow the shoulders, sadden the hearts and dim the eyes of youth as sensitive, ambitious and capable as themselves, that by the frowns of adversity are forced to take upon them tasks that try the courage and test the fidelity of manhood. What need have I to mention the toil, exposure, suffering, anxiety, the weighted upon my young heart, during those long years. Ask the parent, the head of a family, what it is to feel the responsibility of providing for a large circle of helpless ones, and feel that his two arms are their main stay and shield. Throw this load upon the shoulders of a lad that in years is little more than a child, and you will have some conception of burdens that made a stout, bold young heart prematurely thoughtful and grave. I speak not so much of the bodily, physical hardships and toils – they were severe enough, and if they had been lightened by the pleasures pastimes, and merriment that belongs to youth, of themselves they were nothing, but the hard necessity that robs youth and boyhoods of its mirth and gaiety, is the saddest, and hardest to be borne.

I would not have my kind-hearted reader believe that I recall these scenes of my early life with one thought of bitterness or regret. I feel now, as I felt then, that all the hardships I suffered and endured were duties –responsible duties, that I owed to an afflicted father and mother, and my brothers and sister, who were unable at that time make their support.

After a time, a younger brother had grown large enough to assist me in providing for the family, and his assistance afforded me some spare time to work for myself. And being thus relieved by the help my younger brother, when I became of age, I was the owner of a a saddle and bridle; – and kind reader, I would not have you believe that I had in anywise neglected the duties due my aged and afflicted parents, in thus becoming the individual owner of a horse; this little spec of wealth, of which I was now the sole proprietor, was the accumulation of spare hours earned by extra exertions and denial.

My younger brother (Nathaniel Taylor McNabb II b. 1818) being now 16 years of age, I left home (1834), in search of employment. I had an elder brother (Alfred W. McNabb, b. 1809), a Mill-Wright, living 200 miles from father's, and cheered with bright and glowing prospects for the future, I journeyed to his home–not on a whirling lightning express train, as the world today joumeys, but on the patient back of my gentle horse, comsumming days, where now a like trip would not require as many hours, reached my brother's house about the last of Oct. It was some disappointment to me to find that my brother was not working at his trade. He promised me, however, that if I would do his _alls work and help him gather his crop, he would find employment for us both by the close of the year. Acting upon his assurances, I remained with him, and freely rendered the assistance he desired.

At the close of the year, I was without money, and to my surprise as well as mortification, the promises of my brother proved a total failure. At this unhappy and unlooked for result, I left my horse with my brother, and started afoot for a little town in Georgia by the name of Rome, and reached it the following day. Here I found employment at $12.50 per month, and after working 6 months, received a letter from my brother, requesting me to come and get my horse, as he intended moving back to my father's. Rome was 100 miles distant from my brother's. I left Rome with the intention of going back to my father's by the way of my brother's, but when I reached the home of the latter, I found him making arrangements to move to

the Indian Nation. Here again, was a sad disappointment to me, and I am finally yielded to the urgent solicitations of my brother, and went with him to the Indian Nation. My brother, promised me an equal share with himself in farming or in any business in which we might engage.

We reached the Indian country about the first of March and we fenced and cleared about 20 acres; and just as we were about to pitch the crop, there came a man from a considerable distance, to employ my brother to build a mill; an agreement was made between them, and I, of course, had to remain at home and cultivate the crop, and take care of his family. To a young man as I then was, the life I had to lead was very confining. Living in an Indian country, I had to stay close at home, day and night. When not engaged in the crops, I employed myself in clearing more land for the next year's cultivation. One whole year had rolled away ere my brother returned to his home. He came home with plenty of money. I received for my years salary $11.00 in money, and a something else besides, too insignificant to mention. Existing circumstances, as well also, the persuasions of my brother, influenced me in uniting with him in the cultivation of another crop. In the fall, as soon as the crop was matured, we divided the effects. I then built me a house, moved into it and lived alone about four months.

It would scarcely seem necessary to say to my reader, especially if he be blessed with sharp perceptive faculties, that my new house indicated a worthy and sensible purpose. Being now married (m. 1836) and living at home, I partially forgot my past trials and troubles, but it was not long before a sad accident befel me. On the 29th day of March, 1837, I was engaged clearing a piece of timbered land, and while dislodging a tree that had fallen against another, I was severly wounded, and rendered unable to work for nearly a year.

It was now three years since I had seen my father and famly; I concluded, therefore, as soon as I was able to travel, to go and see how they were getting along. I found them living an unfavorable, and I might say uncomfortable condition. My younger brother had left them and had been gone nearly a year. My father insisted that I should come and take care of him as he was in a helpless condition. I returned home, and it was a year before I could make arrangements to pay them another visit. I found my father enthralled with debts, and much reduced in circumstances. I went back home, and returned with my family to my father's, erected for myself a good hewed log house on his premises, and with my own money discharged the principal and most pressing debts against him. And, generous readers, owing to misfortune I had gained only about $300 in my three years absence; but although my portion was but scant, I gave it with good will.

My attention was first directed towards making repairs, and in arrangements for seed-time and harvest. By the time I had made one crop, all my means were exhausted, and the experience of one crop renabled me to see most clearly that on such land in that old country, I could not support two families, and consequently, in the spring of 1840, I moved back and settled in the woods, not far from the place where I was married, to obtain a pre-emption on 160 acres with an allowance of twelve month's time in which to make the payments. Money was scarce, and the prices paid for labor extremely low, and when the twelve months expired, I had just money enough to pay for 80 acres. One of my neighbors prevailed on me to borrow the money and pay for the remaining 80 acres for him, and I did so, acting under assurances from him, that the money would be refunded in a very short time. The short time never came, and I was soon made to feel home that my own little home was placed in a critical condition. The time for making the payment was fast approaching. I went to my neighbor, and spread before him in a clear and truthful light, the condition in which I would soon be placed, if he did not raise the money. I had borrowed for him, and he paid me in words; total inability, total insolvency, and total do nothing. Times were hard, money extremely scarce, and prices for labor almost nothing. I went to a merchant a man of wealth; I stated-the case to him; he listened patiently, and without hesitation, gave me all the money I wished on twelve months time. I then paid my neighbor for his improvements, and took the land. In six months from the time the friendly merchant let me have the money, I paid the debt; money earned by hard labor, and at low prices.

After the foregoing trials, troubles and disappointments, I did not falter, kind reader, in my efforts, but on the contrary, in the heat of summer, I split rails at twenty-five cents per hundred and found myself, to provide the necessaries of life for my then helpless family. We had seven in family, and our circumstances reduced to almost nothing. And now it was that I was brought to meditate upon the vanites of all earthly treasures; That thirty years had now passed away, all, all of it wasted in worldly pursuits, of no real nor lasting importance, and that now I found my self a complete wreck in the midst of it all. The more I reflected on the past, the more I was convinced of the sin and folly of my past life, and that I was now enduring a severe but merciful chastisement. Kind reader and friends, the more I thought, the more I felt the weight of Divine displeasure; my eyes were being opened to a sense of sin and unworthiness; and I trod the path of prayer as a humble penitent search of forgiveness. I obtained it. The quickening influence of God's Holy Spirit, was enkindled in my heart. I was happy and rejoiced I sought the House of God, the Methodist Church, and my name was en rolled as a member. Twenty years have elapsed since then, but not a moment I have not felt composed and resigned to our Heavenly Father's will, and now, beloved and gentle reader, before I leave this subject, let me entrest you, as warmly and earnestly as I would my own dear children, to direct your thoughts to purer, loftier, and holier scenes; put our trust in God's Holy Word, full to overflowing, with the richest treasures, make sure work for the Kingdom of Heaven, and you will be happy amid the direst calamities of earth.

In the fall of 1851, I huddled together my little effects, and emigrated with my little family to Missouri. I settled in the woods near Pleasant Prairie in Webster County. A yoke of oxen, one wagon, and $60 in money, completed my worldly wealth. The winter was very cold and severe, and our prospects seemed unpromising, but the people were friendly, and treated us with great respect. The opening spring was cheering to us all. I went to work in good earnest, cleared ten acres of ground, fenced it and put eight acres in cultivation, rented six more of a neighbor, and for strangers in a new land, all things seemed to move on smoothly. My oldest son was hired out, and a certain man took occasion to treat him with disrespect. I went over to reconcile matters and was treated in the same manner. "Our meeting terminated pugilistically. He sued me at law, and his own neighbors paid the cost and fine for me. I make use of the uncommonly long word "pugilistically," to hide within its folds, even from myself, the deep shame and mortification I feel, and to me this word sounds less harsh, and seems to weaken the force and strength of the fact.

Our health continued good for two years after our arrival in Missouri. From this time, and for five consecutive years, sickness continued its inflictions upon us, and in September 1857, the spirit of our beloved son Mathew took its flight from earth to brighter realms above. Anxiety, fatigue, and loss of sleep prostrated me on a bed of sickness, and when I recovered I resolved to leave Missouri, as soon as I could, in search of a milder and more uniform climate. I left Missouri for Texas, in the fall of 1858, and reached Fannin County with my family, ten in number, and with five cents in my pocket. I had five head of horses to winter, and only five cents to begin with. I rented land of a man who was going to Tennessee on a visit. He left the place and the stock in my care. I was told by several, that this man of whom I rented, was under a bad character, but my necessity compelled me to hold on and risk the consequences. I broke a number of acres with a four-horse team, and pitched a crop. But before harvest the man returned, seemed much pleased with what I had done, and we made an agreeable settlement. I continued with him, sowed wheat, and rented the place for another year. After I had made all the preparations for another winter, he told me he wanted the place for his cousin. I consented, rather than have a difficulty, and sold him my wheat crop. My neighbor's words finally came true, for when pay-day came, he fraudulently deprived me of my wheat crop.

The next season, I rented land of a neighbor, and he was a gentlemen. I cultivated the crops on his land. I now determined to go in search of a piece of land where I could get water and timber convenient. I found it in Cook County (Texas), and moved my family in August 1860, and sheltered under tents on the land until I could erect a building. We were now living 80 miles from Fannin County (Texas). When our house was suffiently comfortable, I returned to Fannin County, to gather my crop and haul it home. My crop being all saved and smugly stowed away at home, I commenced preparations for a crop the coming year on what I now considered my own land. We were all together and ten in number. I had labored for many years, and I felt now more than ever before, that a bright prospect was opening for a quick comfortable and happy home. Meeting together at night, after the toils of the day were over, we would talk over our past reverses in life, humbly kneel to God our Heavenly Father, and retire to rest with peaceful hearts, and composed minds. My little stock was increasing around me, my home, though plain, was snug and comfortable. There was land in abundance for my children to settle around me, and be near me in my old age. I was at peace with God – felt that I had wronged no man, and dear, reader, for one like me who had gone through so much tribulation; my home felt to me somewhat as though it were within the gates of Paradise.

Oh! how painful to me now to recur to what at first only seemed a trifle, but which finally culminated in a serious calamity. In June, 1861, I was taken with the sore eyes, and was confined for some weeks to the house. In Novembe I. was taken with neuralgiac pain in my head and eyes, and in a little time lost my sight. In the spring of 1862, my sight partiely returned, but in July the pains returning, I was again struck blind. The war was now raging with desperate fury; the conscript law was in force; my son, on whom I chiefly depended, enlisted to avoid the conscription, and my other son who was married, also enlisted, and I was left, a blind man in the midst of a helpless family of boys and girls. To heighten the scene of desolation around us, we were living upon the confinds of the Indian District, and they had extended their work of murder and plunder to within a short distance of us. They commenced their dreadful work of murder, arson and plunder, in the fall of 1862, and in the spring of 1863, they completed a scene of murder and outrage, within a mile of our house. Our hopes of safety seemed only in flight, and we traveled away as fast as we could, and did not stop until we had gone 80 miles. Learning shortly after, that a regiment of soldiers was stationed near where we lived, we returned to our home. Shortly after our arrival here, I heard that a skillful Oculist was at Paris, one hundred miles distant, and I obtained a mode of conveyance to Paris, hoping to have my sight restored. The physician sold me medicine, but gave me little or no encouragement, and the man who took me there left me at a tavern. In a short time I was favored by a stranger, who took me in his wagon, as far as the residence of my brother-in-law, within 80 miles of my home. I had been from home about a month. I got a conveyance as soon as I could for I was filled with concern and anxiety about the safety of my family. On our way, at a place where we stopped for the night there was a woman, a stranger, whom I never shall forget. She was a boarder in the family, and had the appearance of being a woman of wealth. Her kind and gentle manners towards me, and words of sympathy, are what I never shall forget, and shall ever love to remember. On leaving the next morning, she offered me money, which I refused to take, saying "that I had enough for present use." She so urged it upon me that I finally accented $1.50 to manifest my appreciation

of her warm and generous feelings. This trip in search of relief cost me $50, and I reached home as I had left it, a blind man, but not disconsolate, for amid the vanity, trials and afflictiors of this life, the soul at peace with its God, rejoiceth, and will rejoice from everlasting to everlasting.

Reader! I was now at home again, and the idea of home carries with something that is comforting and soothing to the breast of every one. One of my sons (James M.) who had joined in the war, was now at home on a sick furlough (Fall of 1863). The Indians had again renewed their ravages and work of destruction, and helpless citizens were now in a state of dreadful consternation. No one had a home of safety for even a single hour. Little groups of aged men and helpless women and children, were to be seen, in every direction collected together by feelings of instant concern. The causes of fear and alarm increasing, our family was rescued by some of our neighbors and we remained with them all night; the next morning my son who had returned home on furlough, went back to see about the horses we had, a band of 150 or 200 Indians discovered and pursued him; once in safety, and now panic-struck with fear, all of us fled quickly as we could to a neighbor's house one mile and a quarter distant. In the house there were huddled together about 60 persons, men women, and children, and very soon the house was surrounded by a bout 180 Indians. There were not over twelve men and boys in the house that were able to give the least protection, and these manifesting so much alarm, caused the women to make an attempt to escape to the woods. At this time, the Indians, being in a body above the house, we managed in making our escape, trying to keep the house between us and the Indians. I was scarcely able to travel, and felt sure of falling a victim to the savages. My dear little daughter, Rebecca (b.1852), of ten years, clung to me all the time. I entreated her to leave me and save wherself by keeping up with the rest; that my strength was almost gone and there seemed but little hope of my safety. But the love and fidelity of this dear child, was not to be overcome by fear or persuasi on. My son assisted me, and we made our escape. The news came that there was a company of fifty soldiers in pursuit of the Indians; that they were in close pursuit. The Indians fled to a high position on the prairie. The soldiers advanced on them and an engagement ensued. The soldiers were driven back a short distance, three of their number being killed, and three wounded. The soldiers soon rallied for a second conflict, advanced and fired on the Indians, who fled, murdering, burning, robbing, as they went. My house with its contents was burned and-horses bout the time of our flight from home, Christmas week of 1864.

We were now adrift in the world, with simply the chothes we wore. Every house and home was being deserted. A large number of us under the guard of soldiers, were taken to a little town (Marysville) about 15 miles distant. It was now winter, and we had but three quilts which were given to us, and one blanket that I usually wore as an overcoat We left the town the next morning for Fannin County, where we rented land and managed to live in a very hard way, until the war closed. My family now wished to move back to the place we had lived in Cook County. We returned to our old place. The County had been made desolate by the Indians, but now, (in 1865) settlers were straggling back to their old bomes; but in the fall several outrages were committed by the Indians, which much alarmed and finally compelled the settlers to "Fort up," by building a number of cabins very close to each other. In the spring of 1866, we pitched a crop, and during the crop season, my son who had been in the army, married, and very soon thereafter sickness came upon us, and we were all helpless, and the stock destroyed the crop efter it was mature. It was now the fall of the year, and myson (Albert Houston McNabb, b.1837) who had remained in Missouri came to see us. As the Indians were still troublesome, he advised me to sell and remove to Missouri.

On our way to Missouri (1867), whilst passing through the Indian Nation an incident occurred, which wrung our hearts with the deepest distress. While in camp on a high (bluff) my oldest son with my two youngest girls went some distance to a steep declivity for some water. On returning up the bank, the elder girl (Harriet) slipped, and was carried in a gently rolling manner down the hill some distance. To avoid the prededing accident, she thought she would go some distance round but in circling round lost the direction to camp. In anon, after she was missed, and the loudest calls were answered by the echoes of the hills and forest. No tongue can express the anguish of our hearts. I was blind and could not look after the little wanderer. After three, or four hours harrowing suspense she came bearing in her hand, a pine bush, which a man present, affirmed could not have been obtained nearer than three miles. The child stated, that when she found that she was lost she listened to hear the ox bell, and having wandered from hil to hill she at last came to a house on a road, and was there directed to our camp.

We reached Missouri with three horses, three yoke of oxes and a wagon. One of the horses died and the other two strayed or were stolen. My youngest son (William A. McNabb, b. Dec. 1850.) remained with me until 1869. I have with me now, my wife and four daughters; and my sons are all gone. My youngest daughter is my help and guide, religion is my comforter, and God is my hope.

Poor wanderers of a stormy day,
From wave to wave were driven,
And Fancy's flash, and Reason's ray,
Serve but to light the troubled way-.
There's nothing calm but Heaven.

Walter Scott McNabb



1874 – 1936

A BRIEF HISTORY

by Walter Craig Davidson

Walter Scott McNabb was born on 12 Jan, 1875 or 5 Dec, 1874, the records vary, in Desdemonia, Eastland County, Texas. He died Sept 4, 1936 in a automobile accident near Hereford, Texas. Walter Scott graduated form Eastland Academy, now Hardin Simmons University in Abilene, Texas. In 1895-96, he worked for his Uncle, Watler Scott's mother's older sister's husband, George Yoakum in Greer County, Oklahoma. Walter Scott returned to Caddo, Palo Pinto County, Texas to marry Birtie Sophia McNeill, born 1879 in Palo Pinto County. Mother Mc, as she later was called, died Nov 23, 1969 in Spearman, Hansford County, Texas. She and her husband, Walter Scott McNabb, are buried in Old Hansford Cemetery, near the Palo Duro Creek in Hansford County, Texas.

After their marriage, Dec 15, 1896, Walter and Birtie went to Greer County, Okla. where Walter continued to work for George Yoakum and also filed on land in his own name. It was on this land on Jan. 22, 1898 that Warren Gilbert McNabb was born. He died in Albuquerque, New Mexico on Sept 4, 1975. Warren was an overseas combat veteran on WWI. Returning to Hansford, Texas after occupation duty in Germany, Warren married Ruth Prutsman of Spearman, Hansford County, Texas on May 18, 1930 in Clayton, New Mexico. They had two children, Beverly Nan born Jan 9, 1932 and Warren Neil born Jan7, 1934, both born in Spearman, Hansford County, Texas.

Sometime during the period of 1898-1900, Walter Scott filed on, or purchased land in Hansford County, Texas. However, the family did not move to Hansford Cty, Texas until a few months after the birth of their daughter, Viola Craig McNabb, born on Feb 12, 1901, on the family farm in Stephens County, Texas.

Walter Scott McNabb was County and District Court Clerk in Hansford Cty, Texas, from 1906-1912. In 1917 he organized and was President of the First State Bank, Hansford County, Texas, later moved 7 miles to Spearman, Texas when the railroad came through Hansford County circa 1920. He sold his controlling interest in the Bank in 1928 and continued in the real estate business, The McNabb Land Co., that he had established in 1902 in Hansford County. Walter Scott McNabb was in the real estate business, throughout the Southwest, from 1902 until his death in an automobile accident, in the vicinity of Hereford, Texas, in 1936. He also brought in several oil wells near Breckenridge, Texas. He helped establish several towns in the Texas and Oklahoma Panhandle bringing in train cars full of purchasers, from not the Eastern United States but from Canada as well. At these sales entire townships would be sold, lot by lot, at auction for cash or letter of credit.

Birtie Sophia (McNeill) McNabb had 2 brothers and 2 sisters. Sister Rose Ella married a Ramsey, and was the mother of Ralph Ramsy of Ranger, Texas, who had 2 sons. Sister Anne Maude married a Jones. Brother Robert McNeill married Emma

Elizabeth Littlepage and had 4 children, James Robert; Golda, who married a Rumfield; Opal Laverne who married first M. Foreman and second Tom Spears and had a daughter by each one; and Jack who married Jessie Hughes.

Warren Gilbert McNabb



1898 – 1975

A Brief History

by Beverly Nan McNabb

Warren Gilbert McNabb was born in 1898 in Greer, Oklahoma Territory. His parents Walter Scott and Birtie McNabb were living in Greer working for an uncle. They later moved back to the family settlement in Central Texas. When Warren was child they moved to the settlement of Hansford, Tx along PaloDuro Creek in Texas Pandhandle. Later they moved to Guymon, Oklahoma.

When Warren was 16 or 17 he was sent to a boarding school in Dallas, Tx. and soon after ran away from the school, lied about his age because the minimum was 18 to join and 19 to go overseas. He joined in EL Paso,Tx. and was stationed army base along TX - Mexico border. Later when USA entered into WorldWar 1 in Europe in 1918 he was sent to France. He was in the front lines of conflict and likely suffered PTSD.

After war was over he returned to Guymon then spent several years wandering from Ok to Canadian border. When he returned home his family had moved to new town of Spearman, Tx built along the new railroad. It was sometime in about 1922 when he began working for his father, WS McNabb at McNabb Land Company, formed in 1902 in Spearman, Tx. They bought and sold land and cattle or arranged sales throughout Texas, Oklahoma, and New Mexico. Also, bought and sold mineral rights to land. Part of their commissions were paid in percentage of mineral rights. These were early days of "Texas Oil Boom".

Warren met Ruth Prutsman a few years later. They married in 1930 and started a family, Nan 1932 then Neil 1934. After his father died in 1936, Warren tried his hand at having a 'cafe' and later a garage gas station. These were days of "great depression" and Warren was not a very good business man as he had difficulity collecting what people owed. Warren soon found work sign painting, house painting, and in summer months he would work at wheat harvest. For several years he took his family on a trek to Colorado while he worked in hay fields and apple harvest.

After Nan and Neil started to school he would work for the railroad painting signs until 1940 when Warren was hired by Santa Fe Railroad as a painter and moved his family to Winslow, Arizona. It was a new and exciting adventure for whole family as Arizona was definitely a lot different from Spearman, Tx. Warren and his family left Winslow in 1950 when he was transfered by the Santa Fe Railroad to Albuquerque, NM where he later retired and spent the remainder of his life.

Ruth Pauline Prutsman



1906 – 1997

A Brief Autobiography

As told to Warren N. & Gerry McNabb,

Summer of 1989.

I was born in Walla Walla, Washington. My parents met and were married in Texas but moved to Washington after my older brother, Charles, was born. All of my father's family had been living in Texas and they all moved to Washington. Most of them settled there.

When my mother and father moved back to Texas, I was three years old. We came on a train. Earl, my brother, was a year old. He threw his shoe out the window. They had windows on the trains then. I can remember one of the brakemen or trainmen threw it back in. We made that trip back to Haskell County. That's where mama's family lived. Her dad was still living and her brothers and her sister also. Those were the Wrights. And mama was so homesick; she was just a kid herself. She didn't like it out in Washington. My dad had a good job there. He drove a Streetcar. All the rest of the Prutsmans stayed there.

We left Haskell county after my brother Lloyd was born, he was just a baby. I was about five. We came in this wagon train. It was a wagon train of three or four wagons. We went to Ochiltree County. No town was near there. It was off of the railroad, near Glazier, Glazier was on the railroad. The towns of Texhoma, Guymon and Glazier was on the railroad.

We moved into a half dugout house and my dad went looking for work. He got acquainted with this Mr. Simmons and he had a farm out in the country. Probably twenty miles from town and he had had a good wheat crop. We moved out there to this farm. Part of the house was filled full of wheat. My dad freighted that wheat because he always had good horses. He freighted that wheat to Canadian to sell it.

We didn't have much to eat that winter except the wheat that was stored in the other rooms of that house. Mama would grind it by hand and cook it up like bulgur wheat. She fixed it in other ways too.

I remember once when we lived in Haskell county, before Lloyd was born, I wasn't even five years old, we went in a wagon to a county fair at Stamford. All I can remember about the county fair was that I got the first store bought ice cream I had ever had, It was in a cone. Of course we had had home made ice cream before, but the thing I remember is eating ice cream in a cone.

When it came spring we were still there. We moved over to another place, some people owned, that was in Ochiltree County. They wanted somebody to live there and farm and we lived there a couple of years. Then the owner sold it or something happened or maybe my dad got a better offer from this man Dodson that had this place where I practically grew

up over there just five mile from the Black's School House. With one exception, we stayed there until after I got out of high school. Then I moved to town and got me a job. I went to Black's school house. A two room school house. It just started out as one room and then they built a new school house with two rooms. They were getting more people around in the county.

The exception was when we went to New Mexico looking for land to homestead. In those days you heard about things by word of mouth. My dad got discouraged on the farm and heard about land available for homesteading in New Mexico near the town of Cuba (in the Jemez Mountains). There was quite a bit of land around Cuba to be filed on for homesteads. So he decided he would give up this farm job he had. He got a percentage of the crop every year. I suppose he had saved money. And we just left everything and took what we could. You didn't have much furniture then, people didn't. Maybe some homemade furniture, just beds, straw ticks. So anyhow, we had two wagons trailed together. Mama drove the little cook shack wagon where we cooked; it had a heater in it. She cooked and we had our meals. I think me and one of the other kids slept in there. We had three wagons. Two of them trailed together and the little cook shack wagon and we started to Cuba, New Mexico.

So, it took quite a while, and in between we got to Bernalillo (New Mexico). And you know, that road from Bernalillo to Cuba it was "Pure-Dee" desert. And we got out in there and got lost, and no water and we almost didn't make it. But we finally got to a spring, I don't know what (the name of) that spring was, not too far from Cuba, where there was water. And we met up with some Mexicans. But when we got on up to Cuba and we got out to this, uh, land that was for homesteading my dad knew several of the families that had moved out there and homesteaded. They was a cutting posts and selling posts for a living. It was, like, pinion and ceder country.

But, you know, my daddy had been on them plains where they raised that wheat clear up to your knees and he just couldn't see cutting fence posts for the rest of his life. And no schools, so we left and we went on to, uh, Colorado to the San Luis Valley. He didn't file on any of the land in New Mexico, you have to live on it to prove it up. He just didn't think you could make a living there. And raise kids, with no school there.

So we left and went on up in the San Luis Valley (in Colorado) and after working in the forest for awhile, he (later) got a job in the potato harvest. He found a job working in the forest before we got on up in the San Luis Valley. He worked at (a town named) Russell. We stopped at Russell to buy groceries and they was hiring men for skidding logs out of the mountains not too far away. There was a camp up there. The Trenchera Lumber Company. A big outfit. They had the commissary there. So he just hired out. He had his horses. And we went up there and stayed all summer. But when it come winter, that shuts down. So that's when we wenton the San Luis Valley for the potato harvest, then through Monte Vista and on up into Pitken, to work in the mines. He worked up in the iron mines that winter and then in the summer he skidded logs, working in the timber again.

We went to school there in Pitken and stayed all winter. He worked in that mine. We was snowed in, you couldn't get out, except, maybe by the train. There was a little train that ran most of the time in the winter. We had a little log house in Pitken. A three or four bedroom log house. And that's the winter that everybody got the Spanish flu; the swine flu. And no doctors or nothing, you just lived or died. Mama almost died. She got it in her lungs and always had emphysema after that.

Then when it come spring he went back to work in the timber. And he had an accident, just about killed him. He broke both legs. So that was the end of the log business. He had this load of logs, to skid them down. He had them on a wagon and the brake lines broke, or something, and it just run off with him, off the side of a mountain. I don't know if it killed his horses or not. I think they had to shoot some of his horses. He had four, two teams. Charles helped him. But Charles either wasn't on the wagon or jumped off or something. So they took my dad over to Salida to the hospital, on the train. And he was over there in the hospital. The timber company hospital over there in Salida. And he finally got able to come home and then soon as he was able, by the end of that summer we went back to Texas. We had been gone about three years.

He went right back to the same job he had left three years before. He just run this farm for these guys. They was good landowners and they did right by him, I suppose. When we had a good crop, we had money. When we had a drought or got hailed out, we lived on credit. This guy would loan him money. The landowner would loan him money to get by through the winter because my dad was a good farmer.

When I moved into town to finish high school, I lived with the family of my friend, Toots Hays. They owned a soda fountain, a "confectionary" they called it then, and Toots and I worked there. It had just ice cream and tables, old fashioned tables. Toots and I ran it. I worked there a year or so and then I got a job at the newspaper office, The Spearman Reporter. It was a weekly paper and I think it's still there. That's where I stayed, I wasn't about to go back to that farm. There was no future at all on the farm.

After we got out of high school, Toots and I went to Oklahoma University for a year, two semesters. My dad made a good wheat crop and ... I don't know why we went to Oklahoma University, we didn't know much about college but we knew somebody that was going there. A friend of ours. Her family moved there so she could go there. We went a year and I've still got all my credits. But then I couldn't go anymore. I couldn't go another year, my dad didn't have the money due to a poor wheat crop. I could have got a certificate to teach after two years but I had to go another year (to qualify).

I went back to work for the Spearman Reporter until you dad came along and whisked me away. His folks had moved back to Spearman, from Guyman, Oklahoma, because there was a big land sale going on and his father was in the real estate business. Your dad had been in Montana and he came back to work with his dad in his real estate business. And I don't know, we just went to basketball games and things like that. He had a good car. He was good to take me and Toots and who ever else wanted to go to Guymon, Oklahoma for basketball games. We played Guymon and Perryton. The roads were all dirt and we would get stuck in the mud. I can't believe I've lived through things like that. Your dad and I met in 1923, when the oil boom hit the Panhandle, that was two years before I graduated from high school in 1925.

My parents split up after your dad and I were married. Mama's health got so bad. And like so many men when they get into that age, they need a younger wife. He (my dad) just made an ass of himself. I was so ashamed of him. I never wanted to see him again. He had bought a quarter of a section of land there next to this farm where we had lived. This Dodson farm. He bought a quarter section of land after one of his good wheat crops. And had it paid for. But then he got the "big eye." So he traded it in on a section of land. It had a big two story house on it. Then things went bad again. The depression hit. And he sold it and bought some kind of ... well, somebody really gave him a snow job I guess, and he traded that land in, with the big house on it, for a business building in Borger, Texas. Borger, that town was booming then. So then he had built a house there in town, there in Spearman. He built that, so Mama could take us kids and go over there and live and the kids could go to school. Well, I was already out of school and on my own by then. And I don't know ... this other woman quit her husband, and her and my dad got married but they didn't stay married. And finally my dad went back to Washington. Earl, my brother, had already gone back to Washington. He (Earl) just wanted to go back ... there wasn't much going on there in the Texas Panhandle during them depression years. So he had to go someplace to make a living. So he moved back to Washington. And he (Earl) was married and him and his wife went back to Washington. And Lloyd and his wife (Mattie) stayed there (in Spearman) and toughed it out. And then the war come on and Lloyd got drafted into the Navy and went to war. And anyhow, my dad, he had made such an ass of himself and made such a mess of his life, so he went to Washington where Earl was. And that's where he was when he died in 1960 or 1961.

I met your dad in 1922 or 23. I was still in high school when I met your dad. He was ten years older than I was. He had a Hutson car. I think he had a Hutson, his dad always liked Hutsons. (Warren N. McNabb: Note. I am not sure about my grandfather and Hutson cars. I have been told that he preferred Mercedes and was driving a Mercedes sedan when he was killed in an auto accident in 1937.) Your dad, you know, he was quite the catch. He had money in his pocket, like the McNabbs'. They either had a pocket full of money or they didn't have nothing.

We were just friends for a long time. We would got to basketball games and other things. Your dad always had a good car and he was good to drive us to the games. You dad was a World War I veteran. He lied about his age and joined the army in 1917 and went to France and fought in the war when he was just a kid himself. He had some terrible experiences during the war and they left him with deep emotional scars. Once his family received notice that he was missing in action and presumed dead. He had a hard time settling down after he came back from the war. He traveled around all over the west for several years. He made his money by playing poker, but he was an honest gambler. Your dad never cheated anybody out of anything.

Your dad learned to play poker while he was in the army. Some old man who was a soldier taught him how. On the troop ship returning from France he won the title to a cattle ranch in Montana. He didn't much think this would amount to anything. But, after he got home to Texas and visited his family for a while he went to Montana and claimed his ranch. It turned out to be a real ranch. He bought some cattle and tried his hand at cattle ranching in Montana. After spending one winter in Montana he just about froze. So in the summer he came back to Texas and sold the ranch. He used the money from the sale to buy a car and made himself a homemade camping trailer and hit the road again. The money from the ranch and the poker playing kept him going for several years. In 1923 he returned to Spearman, Texas to work with his dad in the real estate business.

We knew each other a long time. We were just friends. After I came back from the University of Oklahoma we started dating and began to get more serious about one another. We went together for a long time and then decided to get married. We were married May 18, 1930 in Clayton, New Mexico. So we just decided to get married and drove over to Clayton and got married. We eloped.

For a while after we were married, after you and Nan were born, you dad operated the Spearman Motor Company and we lived in a little rent house around the corner. He didn't sell cars, it was a gas station and garage. He went broke by giving farmers gasoline on credit so they could plant their crops. This was during part of the "dust bowl" and all the crops died and nobody paid your dad what they owed him and he went broke.

We went to Sunray (Texas). Your dad thought sure he would get a job. That was an oil boom town then. There was a carbon black plant there. We bought a lot there in Sunray and parked our little homemade trailer house on it. I planted a garden. He did get some jobs painting signs but he couldn't get a steady job. The depression just kept getting worse. And it was summer time and the heat was terrible. Then they had a pretty good harvest over in the wheat country around

Spearman so he went over there to work in the harvest. And he worked in the harvest all summer and we stayed there in Sunray.

And when he came back, you kids were both sick and it was hot. And he had made some money. And he said, "Lets just pile the kids in the car and head for the mountains. Lets go to Colorado." Well, I was always ready to go, just give me time to grab my purse. So, that's what we did. We left our little shack there. There were some other people living there nearby. People lived in tents, all around, you know. Nobody had any money.

He had built a little front (porch) on our trailer house and we had a little ice box we kept out there but we could lock the door to the rest of it. I planted a little garden out there. Well, anyhow, we went up through the San Luis Valley. We went though Clayton. We left Sunray and went to Texline. Oh, it was hot, right in the middle of July. But he would stop to paint signs. He would paint signs along the way to keep us in money for gasoline and a little food. We stayed there a couple or three days and he got his sign money and then we just moved on north and we got up there to Colorado.

And we went over the La Veta Pass, we made that trip all in one day through the heat. We got up into the mountains and stopped at the foot of the pass, And there was water running, little creeks everywhere and we pulled up there and camped for the night. And we all took a bath in them creeks and like to froze to death. And then the next day we on over the pass and on in to Colorado. We went to Saguache, at the end of the "Gun Barrel Highway." Your dad got a job at a ranch and worked in the hay all summer. We had a good summer. He would kill cotton tails and I would fry'em and fix cornbread. You and he and Nan would eat them. I wouldn't eat them, but I'd eat the cornbread. I cooked on a campfire all summer. We just camped out there, it was so cool and so good to be out of the heat. That was when dirt (storms) was covering up the Texas Panhandle, we just couldn't do nothing there.

And when that was done, we went on over to Canyon City and picked apples until they was all done. And then we didn't have nowhere else to go, so we went back to Spearman. Nan was old enough to start to school that fall.

Sometimes, on weekends, we would go to Palo Dura Creek and have a picnic. It wasn't far from Spearman. We'd make us some homemade ice cream using two buckets. We would put the ice and salt in a water bucket. And we had a syrup bucket. You would put the syrup bucket in the water bucket that had the ice and salt in it. You would have to turn the syrup bucket for a while and then take the top off and stir it and scrape the frozen cream off the sides until it was all frozen. We would just lay in the shade and eat ice cream and what ever else we had to eat. Your dad would read the Sunday edition of the Denver Post. He would make willow whistles for you and Nan. We always had a good time.

WARREN N. McNABB — ADDENDUM

This is the end of my mother's narrative. We lived in Spearman, Texas for several years after the first trip to Colorado, My dad never found a steady job during the depression. We returned to Colorado to work the hay harvest another summer, in 1940, My folks worked the apple harvest in Colorado again on the way back home to Texas. I cherish the memories of this trip. I had a great summer. I was old enough to go fishing with a willow pole, get lost in the woods and generally have a wonderful time. It was, however, my last great adventure for many years. I started to school in the first grade that fall.

Warren Neil McNabb



1934 – 2025

SINCE LEAVING WINSLOW, AZ

by Warren (Neil) McNabb

This story begins with two people sitting on the sun drenched iron steps of the fire escape outside the old auditorium/gymnasium at Winslow High School. One of these people was a wild adventurous boy. The other was a young coach. As usual the boy was in trouble.

The coach was saying, "If you continue this way you are headed for trouble. If you don't change your attitude you are going to find yourself on the outside looking in, and in the long run you will be left out and left behind."

We talked for a few minutes more, the coach elaborating on his opening statement. I remember being impressed by his genuine concern. I was not a good listener in those days and Coach Nasser likely thought his words never found a place in my memory, but they did. I remembered them many times in the months and years that followed, and they helped me change my attitude and approach to life. When I later reflected on our conversation that day I was thankful he had taken the time to try to set me straight. He had a busy schedule, and I'm sure he had more important things to do. However, his words played an important role in my life. I never forgot them.

After my sister graduated from Winslow High School in 1950 my family moved to Albuquerque, New Mexico. I spent my last two years of high school there graduating in 1952. I studied hard at Albuquerque High School. I made up the classes I had dropped at Winslow, and I changed my major from vocational to college prep.

I met my high school sweetheart in one of the classes I was making up, and we were married a few months after graduation. We have three children. Our son, the oldest, graduated from New Mexico Tech with a degree in computer science and works for the Albuquerque/Bernalillo County Metropolitan Government. Our oldest daughter has a degree in accounting from the University of Louisville, Kentucky, and works for the Pet Smart Corp. Our youngest daughter is married with four children, and lives in Scottsdale, Arizona. Her husband is the regional manager for a real estate management company.

After completing high school I worked for the Santa Fe Railroad for two years, and then worked for the phone company for a few years. The phone company job introduced me to electricity and electronics, and I started attending evening classes at UNM. I had joined the National Guard some time previous to this and elected to go on active duty in the US Army at Ft Bliss, TX to attend electronics and missile schools.

After graduating from the US Army schools, and being released from active duty, I stayed on at Ft. Bliss as an electronics instructor working for the Philco Corporation. In those days, the electronics industry was booming and big companies were competing for knowledgeable technical people. I was lured away from Philco by Raytheon Company, and hired on with them in 1959 as a test engineer on HAWK missile system at their facility in El Paso, Texas. I later did some circuit design work for Raytheon and was eventually promoted into engineering management.

I spent thirty-three years with Raytheon. In the early sixties I accepted a couple of temporary assignments overseas, first to Germany, then, the next year, to Italy. A few years later I accepted an assignment to Germany as the Quality Assurance Manager in a missile equipment depot that Raytheon operated for the US Army. I spent four years on that job and we had a great time touring Europe on vacations and holidays.

At the end of the assignment in Germany I returned to the US for five years, and then accepted a job as Technical Operations Manager on Project Peace Shield in Iran. Project Peace Shield was a program to modernize the Iranian Armed Forces. Raytheon was responsible for installing Hawk missile sites throughout the country, and training Iranian military personnel to operate and maintain the missiles and related equipment. In those days Iran was full of excitement and adventure, and it was a fascinating place to live and work. After two years in Iran I was offered a similar job on a new program in Kuwait. We spent seven years in Kuwait, and observed the Iranian revolution from across the Persian Gulf, and also weathered the political upheavals of the Iran/Iraq war.

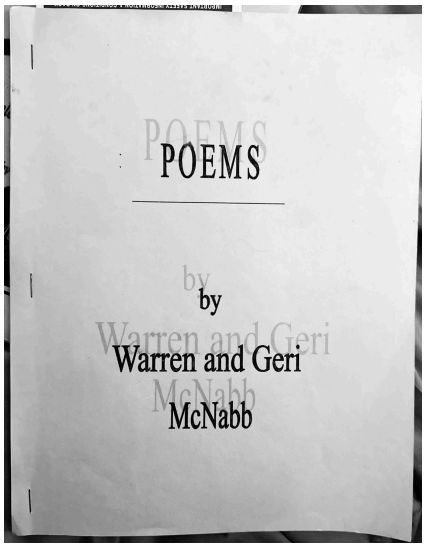
We returned to the States in 1983 where I spent the remainder of my career with Raytheon serving in various management positions of increasing responsibility. In 1992 with all our children grown and married I elected to take early retirement. My wife and I then moved to our farm in Missouri we bought many years ago where we now raise beef cattle.

BEVERLY NAN McNABB — ADDENDUM

Neil and his wife, Geri, spent many years living on their Missouri farm. As they aged, the demands of tending to cattle grew too strenuous, prompting them to sell the herd. They remained on the farm for several more years, enjoying frequent visits from their children, grandchildren, and other relatives. One memorable year, they hosted a family reunion, an event filled with joy for everyone involved.

In 2015, recognizing the need to be nearer to medical services, shopping, and other conveniences as they grew older, Neil and Geri sold the farm and relocated to Joplin, Missouri. They downsized into a new home, adapting to the rhythms of city life. Tragedy struck over the following years: their son, Scott, passed away in 2020, Geri followed in 2023, and their daughter, Valerie, in 2024. Neil carried on alone after Geri's death until March 2025.

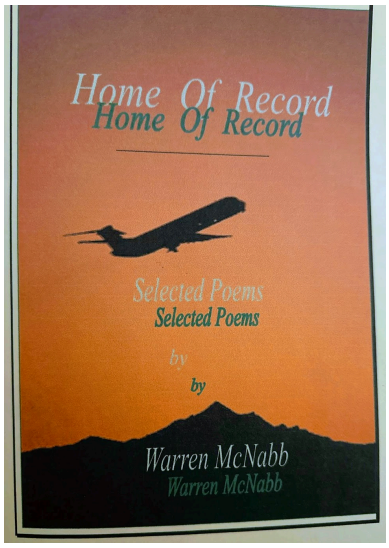
Poetry Collection (1998)



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Home of Record (1999)



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A Note To The Reader:

These poems are about life. There is an abundance of stories in every life; the following are some of mine. Most of these sketches are related to my own observations and experiences. However, the storyteller is not always the person in the story. For example, The Veteran, is not my story but one I heard from an acquaintance. I simply set it to verse. In addition, I occasionally allowed myself some poetic license because that is part of the fun.

I guess I always had poetry lurking around somewhere in my brain. Before now, I just never had time to listen to it.

Home Of Record was my first poem and it is first here. First poems are frontiers, from them you start to learn, and the journey begins. People sometimes help with criticism or encouragement and you go on from there. To paraphrase the late Charles M Russell, "There are lots better poets than me, and maybe some worse." I hope you enjoy these poems.

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Poetry Collection (1998)

My Old Man

My Old Man was a helluva' guy
He taught me to love nature and enjoy the night sky.
He always said don't be rough when gentle will do,
Take your time, you'll get through.
Don't do things just to make your self look good,
Be helpful and patient around the neighborhood.
I miss him now that he's gone and one thing for sure,
The older I get the more his advice seems pure.

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Southern Girl

When I was a little girl no more than three
My mother would pick cotton, I'd play under a tree.
The days were hot and the rows were long
She sang as she worked, her favorite songs.

Sometimes I 'd get to ride on the cotton sack
It was bumpy and rough as I lay on my back
But I didn't mind 'cause I'd hear her sweet voice
When the day was over, it was time to rejoice.

We'd go in to supper and get ready for bed
For tomorrow we had a long day ahead
My mother worked hard from sunrise to sundown
She never complained, she loved this ground

When the cotton was picked it went to the gin
Then next year she'd help plant it all over again.
The cycle repeated in nature's own time
She worked in the fields long past her prime.

My mother is gone now, but I still remember
Just as though it were last December
She looks down from above with a smile on her face
Saying we were poor but we had God's good grace.

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LOVE SONG

That day in class I saw you smile
I knew our love would last a while
Fifty years have passed since that day
I think our love is here to stay.

Your laughing eyes pierced my heart
No one else could play your part
Friend and lover both in one
Passion sure, but also fun.

At football games in autumns clear
We huddled close amid the cheer
Our teachers watched with silent smile
Never scolding, knowing all the while.

We married at a tender age
Love not years was our gauge
Friends thought we were too young,
Our love song needed sung.

Once when love grew thin
Heartbreaks from without and within
Our precious fire never died
We overcame because we tried.

Laughing in your warm bed at night
We put stress and worry both to flight
Those priceless moments of desire
Sustained and fueled our secret fire.

Now as we live through the best part
Closer to the ending than the start
There's one more thing I need to say
I love you more everyday.

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RETIREMENT

To the tune of Pearl Bailey singing, "He's Gone." Apologies to Ms. Bailey.



Listen to RETIREMENT

No more working at the office
Until the middle of the night,
No more free labor on the weekends
To relieve the company's fiscal plight

No more trying to explain
Why the overhead has gone outa sight,
No more fudging of the figures
To make the profit look just right

No more racing through the rain
To catch that early morning flight,
No more fret and worry cause
My blood pressure is a fright.

I'm gone, I'm gone, I'm gone
And I'm so thankful I'm retired
My only nightmare is that I
Sometimes dream I'm re-hired!

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IN AUTUMN

Walking in the fields in autumn, this thoughtful time of year
Purring insects crowd my passage beneath a waning sun
Harvest crops stored safe away, winter drawing near.
Another summer's seen it's season; a few chores left still undone.
A rusty colored red tailed hawk atop a yellow bale of hay
Raptor's eyes searching windblown grass for an evening meal,
Tattered feathers show some wear; he has seen a better day.
In me you see that same span of season, a silvery kind of feel.
Dreaming of some pleasure past I scarcely sense the wind
Branches sway and dry leaves rasp against their stalk
Time slips by unnoticed until the daydreams end,
I stir then, and stretch, and continue on my walk.

Reflecting on my days in autumn, a few things left still undone
Perhaps there will be time to finish before the coming winter's sun.

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Remembering My First Airplane Ride

It was one of those warm days in early December,
My friends have forgot but I still remember.
I was just a kid in a small town in Texas
One day an old biplane landed in the field next to us.

When it bumped to a stop, a dusty pilot got down
He said, "For five bucks I'll fly you all over this town.
We were just kids, we didn't have any money
We suggested free rides, he didn't think it was funny.

Just then a roadster drove up with two guys and a girl.
They gave the pilot twenty bucks and said, "Let's go for a whirl."
When their rides were all over it was late in the day
My friends had gone home, they couldn't stay.

The pilot said, "Those people paid for four rides but only took three,
Hop in the plane kid, this one's on me."
We flew all over the town, it was so grand,
When it was over I didn't want to land.

He gave me a pair of old goggles, I've still got'em today.
Then with a smile and a wave he went on his way.
It was one of those warm days in early December
My friends have forgot but I still remember.

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Once while walking in a quiet garden I saw a brass sundial. The inscription on its weathered face read, "Time takes all but memories."

Looking Out The Nursing Home Window

Do you ever wish you could go back again,
And see it now, the way it was then?
With memories so clear, you could still smell the wind
And make the same journey, through to the end.

They say that time is a river flowing slowly along
But the crossing seems swift if the boatman pulls strong.
If you could capture a moment to savor once more
Which bend in the stream would you choose to explore?

Success and praise you earned with hard labor,
Reflections of someone, a mate and a lover,
The laughter of children, like a bubbling brook.
Cascades of memories merged in a quiet nook.

Would you like to go back and see it again,
And visit that cheerful, sunburned old clan.
Picnics and ballgames; your summer was long.
A tale of this voyage wouldn't be a sad song.

Time and tides wash away the physical things,
Sense keeps memories from taking their wings,
When too many seasons cause reason to flee
It's time for the Captain to let the servant go free.

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I got the idea for this poem in London. Every afternoon the same two old men would be sitting on the same park bench, watching children playing soccer nearby. I never really knew who they were but I noticed the London knete as they walked by. I imagined they were pensioned old soldiers with them a litte Victoria Cross for gallantry in some forgotten war.

KENSINGTON PARK

They were just two old men
Who came to the park everyday.
Us kids hardly noticed them,
And continued our play.

Just two old men
So harmless, so frail and benign
Who would have dreamed
They were once fierce soldiers so fine.

Our ball bounced up to their bench
And lay there a while
They pushed it back with their canes
And then gave us a smile.

These two old soldiers
With ill fitting clothes and watery eyes,
When they were young
Won their nations best prize.

One afternoon they got drunk on vodka,
Reminiscing, happily laughing, and gay.
Natasha's mother had the police
Come and take them away.

These two old war heroes
Quite famous in their day,
Now just two old men
Watching children play.

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The Day After Pay Day

Grunting, cursing, sweating, straining
To lift one more oozing creosoted timber
Into place on the bridge; responding to the
Foreman's chant of "Arriba!" We labor on.

The smell of stale whiskey breath and tortillas
Cooked in rancid lard mixed with the stink of
Cigarette smoke and bodies that forgot to bathe
Is strong in the warm morning air.

Our short, fat, red faced foreman, chewing
On the flaccid stub of a wet cigar waves his
Short arms and bellows, "Carl, Frosty, Red,
Show those new men how to set that stringer!"

Three old timers drop what they are doing
And gather around us. Self-conscious, coached,
And clumsy we give a final heave. At last,
The heavy stringer slides into alignment.

Damned by the effects of the desiccating
Desert sun and too much whiskey the night
Before, feeling like pieces of dry leather,
We pray for the arrival of noon.

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CAMPFIRE AT NIGHT

When the desert cools down at the beginning of night
It becomes a peculiar place near the end of the day
After the sun dips low then fades out of sight,
And the twilight enchants in its curious way.

It's about this time, near the beginning of dark
When things seem to shift and take on a new form,
Creatures that scurry and rustle rove nature's vast park
And stars and planets their nightly excursions perform.

As the sand gives its heat back to the space
And a juniper fire burns with a fragrant flame
It's then old friendships don't feel out of place,
And I'd rather be here than have world acclaim.

A small circle of pals by the fire's friendly glow
Trust, quiet talk, and friendship that never betrays,
Drinking strong campfire coffee, in seasons long ago.
I'd trade some tomorrows for those old yesterdays.

Then soon it's time for the last drink and the last story
Told around the flames of the slow dying fire,
Old friends and campaigners remember their glory,
Their hoarse wintry voices a venerable choir.

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The June Bugs Came In May This Year

All the flowers, Even the June Bugs,
Came in early this year.

I wish you could have been here
With me this spring to see the profusions
Of Bluets and Johnny-Jump-Ups,
All the beds of Daffodils and fields of Daisies.

The little back pasture was covered
With wild flowers. Somehow I never
Found time to mow it this year.

Life seems so precious now,
I couldn't even step on a June Bug
That flew up on the porch.

God was gentle, we had time
To say goodbye. But I wish I could hold
Your careworn hands one more time.

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SNOWFLAKES

The pain usually wakes me
In the morning around four
I lie in the bed until
I can't take it no more.

That's why I stay awake
Watching a late TV show
With the volume turned down,
So the neighbors won't know.

The doctor gave me some
Pills as big as your thumb
I eat them like candy
But still don't get numb.

They won't give me anything
Stronger, I begged and pleaded
They say that stuff's addicting,
And it's more than I needed.

I wish they could be me
And feel some of this pain
But they just poke and they mutter
And send me home once again.

I sat by the window
Watching school kids today
They're at their beginning,
While I'm just sliding away.

This is like stumbling
Backwards down a steep slope
There is no way back up
And there's surely no hope.

The end doesn't scare me
We all have to die,
I've not much to live for
And there's no one to cry.

You've been a true friend,
My God, the times that we had!
For me it's almost all over,
Don't let that make you feel sad.

We've had a good talk,
This may be our last call
I'll get some rest now
I hear the nurse in the hall.

I got word on my birthday
Of course I'll never forget
He died early that morning

Quietly, with little regret.

I put down the phone
And looked out at the snow
Thinking life is a snowflake,
Melting; where does it go?

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WHAT MOTIVATES ME?

Not much of anything in this hot weather
I just flop around from couch to chair
And sit on the porch watching clouds gather
Hoping this afternoon will be cloudy instead of fair.

In this kind of summer nobody moves fast and
I just can't get enthused about hauling in hay
Maybe I need to find some young hired hand.
I dream about going fishing but it's too hot today.

My back feels about as stiff as a chunk of old bark
And my movements have lost their former fluidity
As the folks around here are prone to remark,
"It ain't so much the heat as it is the humidity."

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LIMERICKS FOR A RAINY WEDNESDAY

When cleaning out old cattle chutes
It is best to wear high rubber boots
If you get in a hurry
And slip in the slurry
You'll wish you had chosen other pursuits.

I once had a white cat named Biddle
I thought he was fit as a fiddle
When under the bed I found him quite dead.
How he got that way is still a big riddle.

If you ever go for a short drive in Tehran
You'll find streetwalkers there despite the ban
They wear high leather boots
And wave at old coots
Driving by in their shiny sedan.

One night at the AARP Po'try chat
The poems were about this and that
We had limericks galore
And we all yelled for more
Because this is our favorite format.

There was a young lass from Bizerte,
Her lovers thought she was quite flirty
She had eyes of light blue
And sure loved to... stew
Ah ha! You thought this was going to be dirty.

I once bought a tractor from Russia
It was cheaper than the one sold by Prussia
While driving through the crud
The wheels fell off in the mud,
You had to watch out or it would crush ya.

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GERI'S LIMERICKS

FLOUR SACK DRESS

Did you ever wear a flour sack dress,
With buttons and bows and all the rest,
With a pink ribbon tied,
And a clean scrubbed hide,
To church on sunday looking your best?

NED

We have a young bull named Ned
Who has never yet been bred
A heifer that's smart
Has stolen his heart
And he's dreaming of what lies ahead

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MORE LIMERICKS

I have an old horse name of Speck
Who is most times a pain in the neck
He rips open feed sacks
For his midday snacks
And he then leaves my stable a wreck.

Our little red tractor named Bell
Was once not running well
Her voltage was low
And she wouldn't go
Some new batteries made her work swell.

A raccoon comes to our house for dinner
He thinks the cat food is a winner
He rattles the plates
And sometimes brings mates
They're all getting fatter, not thinner.

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Ghosts Of Christmas's Past

Snow, abundant, whispering down, quickly covers the city,
Black asphalt streets now white runways with dark tracks.
Bare trees and shrubs grow thick with the windless wet snow,
Streetlights beam halos through the softly shining flakes.

The fascinating silence of snow filled streets,
With lights blinking through the crystalline fog
Delight us as we descend from the foothills to
The city for a holiday nightcap at our old rendezvous.

Downtown, this grand old hotel, refurbished now,
Its quiet lounge with dark wood, pale candles
Glowing in the soft light and muted sounds
Retains the graceful charm of an earlier time.

The lounge is almost empty. As we enter, the
Bartender looks up, checks out your taut black
Spaghetti straps, and smiles. Trio playing smooth
And low, good piano, great bass, our kind of place.

Sitting here with you in this familiar safe harbor
Old times and Christmas's past come alive again.
Memories, pulsing, panning into soft focus become
A gentle glow on the hazy screen of recollection.

Dancing close and slow, music encloses us.
Inhaling your musk, rich and warm, mixed
With the faint fragrance of a lingering perfume;
Time stands still for us one more time.

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Lookin' Toward Home

When the first pale pink streamers
Of dawn give way to fragile shades
Of pastel and finally fade away
Before the steady drum roll of
The emerging yellow sun, I whisper,
"Thanks Again."

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Home of Record (1999)

HOME OF RECORD

The old excitement is always the same
A foreign assignment is part of the game.
This business demands you go when they call,
The time or season doesn't much matter at all.

There is always a sadness when I'm leaving home
It makes me feel lonely but I've got to roam.
This time they are sending me to places far and remote,
Where the customs are quaint and peculiar," they quote

Friends say, "Goodbye, we'll miss you this fall
When cottonwoods turn golden and quail start to call,
The sport's not the same when you're one of the missing
And the lake's best in autumn for serious fishing."

"We'll miss you on New Year's, hell, we'll drink you a toast."
Then at the party they gave me a roast.
Good-byes and good wishes, "Don't forget us," they say.
I take it all in… But I'm on my way.

My orders' approved, the plane leaves tomorrow,
When I kiss her goodbye I feel sincere sorrow,
I say I'll return when the assignment is over
She wants to believe, but her lover's a rover.

I'll miss her soft hands, talking late by the fire
Of enduring arrangements that women desire.
She's a good woman, I'd like to stay longer
But adventure's my mistress, her call is stronger.

The unknown's a mystery that lures me along
I hunger inside to hear the sirens' old song.
It's a craving from within I try to repress
Satisfied only by travel, adventure and stress.

This journey's a long one, it will last all my life
To stay long in one place just causes me strife.
Sometimes I wish I could settle but I never will
Always searching for something, just over the hill.

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Fixin' Fences

Getting finally to the end of the fence
We watch the red orange ball of the sun
Slipping down the curtain of the horizon
Signaling our long workday done.

I shift in the stirrups and slide down
Easing weight from this old horse's back,
Low lying clouds now reflecting red,
I drop my fence pliers in the steeple sack.

We stand watching twilight gather,
Longtime friends, just me and him
Countless evenings spent this way
Watching days grow dim.

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Lament For A Long Dead Friend

You know how it is in the morning
At first light. The terrain drab.
Thin Fog in the low places. Foliage
Coloring from gray to green as the
Sun breaks over the horizon lighting
The tops of gnarled mesquite trees.

We stood solemnly watching droves
Of dove winging in from Mexico to
The green irrigated fields of Texas.
Me poised with my old over/under
All set to go, two extra shells clutched
Between the fingers of my left
Hand ready for a quick reload.

You with your shotgun in one
Hand and a can of Coors in the
Other. When the birds drew close
You yelled, "Incoming," and
Laughed like hell causing the birds
To suddenly veer off like a school
Of frightened bait fish. Idiot.

But I still remember you on the
First morning of dove season
And sometimes in the evening
When I open a new bottle of Hoppes #9.

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Lago Di Garda

The warm wind is still.
Motionless water
Catches the sky in
A quiet mirror.
Cumulus clouds drift,
Rearranging the
Soporific scene.

Slow moving shoppers
On dusty streets grow
Few in midday heat.
Drowsy shopkeepers
Close shutters and doors
Eager for the noon
Meal and siesta.

The late afternoon
Ferry pulls in with
Hissing hydrofoils
And blasting klaxon.
Few people notice.
The village slumbers,
Pillowed in soft dreams.

At last, the heat of
The day is broken.
A gentle breeze stirs,
Shop doors are unlocked
Shutters raised, streets
Fill with people.
The Village awakens.

Harsh daylight softens
As the sun slips down.
Sharp shadows lengthen
Then fade as darkness
Overtakes them.
The Quiet mirror now
Reflects the night sky.

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Doc Long's Cabin

Topping the rise, pulse pounding,
Dizzy from the long climb,
I lean against a tree and adjust
The sternum strap of the heavy pack.

Below me, snug in the
Small valley, I see the rusty
Tin roof of the old cabin
Its porch sagging on tired timbers.

The door stands open the interior dim
With a mixture of accumulated
Dirt, dust and evidence of
Social calls by curious animals.

No one comes here anymore
Since the logging road was
Closed over ten years ago,
My solitude is complete.

I pitch the filmy nylon tent
Close by a gnarled juniper
The ground beneath it soft
With dry grass and shed needles.

Staring into the fire after dinner
I linger over a cup of fragrant tea,
Its aroma reminds me of the scent
Of your hair fresh after a shower.

Dozing I dream of good times
And remember that old photo
Of you in a soft summer dress
Standing in front of our first house.

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Of Lions And Ladies

We would stop in Soho
And have a few pints there
Then saunter down the street
Toward Trafalgar Square.

Where regal stone lions
Repose with quiet dignity
Guarding Britain's tribute
To Lord Nelson's victory

What a bonny place to
Be on a summer night
To watch the girls stroll by
In the soft sunset light.

The lions don't seem to notice
They stare with tranquil grace
Waiting for a maiden
To appear before their place.

For when a virgin passes by
As clearly states the lore,
If that should ever happen,
Those great stone lions will roar!

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Renewable Pleasures

We glide away from the dock
And catch the wind. Sails billow
Then snap sharply, as the boat
Accelerates in the breeze. L
ines pull taut and strain, singing
With stress as I trim the sail.
Our wake curls gracefully back.

Cruising, we loll in the stern
Trailing our hands in clear cold
Water. Lithe bodies lying
Warm in the sun we are youth,
Boundless, indestructible.
Time can never affect us,
We are callow and convinced

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Dos Mariposas

Lying on damp sheets, spent. Night
Wind through an open window
Billows the pale curtains and
Dissolves the warm vapors of
Love. Your Leg soft across mine,
Lightly like a butterfly.

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Fridays

It's funny how things work out sometimes.
I was the one who wanted to move out
And get an apartment in the city where
I was spending most of my time anyhow.

My star was just beginning to rise then
And I didn't want any distractions,
I needed all my energies for the job.
That seems like a long time ago now.

Tonight, a rainy Friday at the Atlanta Airport,
I saw a woman with a sassy ass in a skirt
Like those you used to wear.
For a moment I thought it was you.

I've worked hard to get where I am today,
I used to think the job was all I needed but
Sometimes now I think back to Friday evenings
When I was coming home to you.

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Conversation Over Morning Coffee

Geri sez, "Did you make this coffee?"
I sez, "Nope."
Geri sez, "Is this yesterdays coffee?"
I sez, "Yup."
Geri sez, "This is awful."
I sez, "Yup."
Geri sez, "I can't drink this."
I sez, "Nope."
Geri sez, "I'll make some fresh."
I sez, "OK."
"There," she says, "Better?"
"Yup."

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Bare Feet In Seventeen Syllables

(Not Haiku but maybe, Hike-U)
Bare feet young and wet
Walking in the summer rain
When we were children.

Bare feet tired and wet
In the locker room after
Winning the big game.

Bare feet warm and wet
In the shower at the
Niagara Inn.

Bare feet worn and wet
Soak in a heated basin
By my rocking chair.

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The Night Calvin Clark Died

Nobody ever knew I was with
Old Calvin Clark the night he died.
We were sitting in his shack out
On the edge of town. Calvin was
Drinking from a bottle of Four
Roses Whiskey, and wearing his
Gray Stetson hat and pistol belt,
Telling me about the time him

And Doc Long got into a fight
One Saturday night at a dance
Up at Mormon Lake Lodge and Doc
Got put in jail but Cal didn't.
He was laughing at the memory
When he lit up a Lucky Strike
And took another drink out of
That flask of strong smelling whiskey.

Next he had a coughing fit like
He sometimes did but this time he
Couldn't stop and fell out of his
Chair and hit the floor with a whump.
When I saw there wasn't anything
Could be done for him I grabbed the
Revolver out of his gun belt
And then took off on a dead run.

The newspaper said he died while
Drinking alone and his pistol
Was gone but suspect no foul play.
I missed Calvin for a long time.
He used to take me fishing down
By the dam on Clear Creek. I still
Own the pistol. Old Calvin would
Have gotten a kick out of that.

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God Be With You Gentle Father

My dad would have liked this place,
In the open shade of a large old
Chinaberry tree, on a slight rise above
The dusty desert floor. Arid mountains
Outline the horizon. I can hear a lonely
Gamble's quail calling "cha-keet-aah,
cha-keet-aah," in a raspy voice.

As the echoes of the last volley fired
Over the casket die away across
The desert landscape, a weathered
Bugler with a lined and leathery
Face begins his sorrowful solo.
Finally the flag draping the casket
Is folded and placed in my mother's
Trembling hands.

Dominus vobiscum, gentle father
Who cried at my sister's wedding.

Dominus vobiscum, gentle father
Who never stopped loving this
Wild adventurous boy who
Broke your heart.

Dominus vobiscum, gentle father.

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From Notes At Verdun, 1966

Yellow daffodil blowing in the wind.
Thy tender beauty could have never sinned.
Pastel blossom with ornate life so brief,
Tattered soon like drab autumn's weathered leaf.

Frail flower can thy xylem ever know
I walked in fields where lonely poppies blow,
Fog and rain my morose companions there
Where nightly phantoms of old battles flare.

This ground where sleeps below our precious dead
Freed now from passion, longing, fear and dread.
Patriotic sons thunderstruck by fate
They early made their call at heaven's gate.

Heroes whose nations begged to give their all.
Who prayed each night before the trumpet's call
"God save me from this terrifying flood
Tho' I am black with sin and stained with blood."

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They used to meet at the Jade Room Club And drink and laugh and woo those limber ladies.

The Veteran

Sometimes the phantoms
By my bedside stare
Throughout the night.

In the dream I
Clench my teeth
And sweat with fright.

I feel the Huey
Pitch and roll
As we evade.

This is so far
From the music
And the parade.

Why does the
Dream haunt
Me so?

We all killed a few.
I was there,
I oughta know.

But their fading
Faces sear my
Soul.

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No Rusty Swords

This new war is not about shifting
Attention from Bill and Monica.
It is not about the "Domino Effect."
It is not about saving Southeast Asia
From communism. It is not about
Protecting the oilfields of Kuwait.

This new war is about genocide.
We are a powerful and generous nation
Let us have no rusty swords when it comes
To protecting innocent people from calculated
And systematic slaughter by a madman.

If you have ever looked at the aging
Photos of naked, terrified Jewish
Women being herded past lines of jeering
SS troopers to the showers at Auschwitz
Then you know what I am talking about.

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The Late Show

My old enemy glares back at me
As I stare at him in the hallway
Mirror. He looks older than I do.
I suspect he hates me. Small wonder,
I have put him though a lot.

I drove him hard most of his life.
For years I desiccated his lungs
With tobacco smoke and dosed
Him liberally with alcohol to
Relieve his stress. No wonder he
Looks so old.

But as I look closer, maybe he doesn't
Look quite as bad as a few years ago.
Cigarettes are a folly of the distant
Past and the only alcohol now is a
Glass of wine on rare special occasions.
Maybe all that yogurt and tofu along
With the vitamins and supplements
And work on the ranch has paid off.

Retirement seems to agree with him.
The face is thinner, the paunch gone.
Shortness of breathe now only a memory.
I have been treating him pretty good lately.
Maybe we could learn to be friends after all.

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That Old Song

What song is this I hear you sing again?
A half remembered tune so vague in time
That starts a restless humming in my brain
And sets my mind to searching for its rhyme.

Its melody returns sweet memories
From times long past. Still now I heed your call.
I journey back in silent reveries.
Your lovely silken song recalls them all.

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Yarnell Hill

When I pulled into Rip Griffith's
Truck Stop and Restaurant at the top
Of Yarnell hill the heat of the day was
Just starting to build in the desert below.

Inside the dingy office I drew a large
Cup of coffee and got a package
Of stale sweet rolls off the counter.

"You must be headed home to mama
tonight," Doc said as he made change,
"You don't usually pull the hill until
Around noon."

"Hell," I said, "I'm so anxious to get home
I came up Yarnell Hill in high gear."

Doc shifted his toothpick to the
Other side of this mouth looking,
With faded blue gun fighter eyes,
Off into the heat waves rising
From the desert hills, remembering
When he was somebody around here.

Times when people knew his name.
In his heyday back before the war, years
ago, before he started pumping gas and
tending the register here at the truck stop.

He stared at me, coughing to shake off
Some of the bitter chills of old age.
"Ain't nobody ever come up Yarnell
Hill in high gear," he said in a menacing
Whisper through dry thin lips,
"Not even you!"

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Vespers

When day's sharp sun formed
Shadows begin their evening fade
And the wind shifts to accept a new night,
Then twilight's footprints tread into my glade.

As sunset's darkness falls, blowing out the light,
The landscape is soon dim slate-color draped
A nighthawk's mournful voice quivers and
Day's tensions all at last escaped.
Now I pray.

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Christmas Eve

A Mercedes sedan hisses by on the wet street
It's high-pitched exhaust resonating as the driver
Accelerates toward Friedberg, dim in the distance.

Snow crunches under our shoes as we stroll
Past shop windows decorated for the season.
Strings of clear electric bulbs adorn the square.

A gust of wind, blowing across the soccer field,
From the direction of the school carries the
Sound of children's voices singing "Tannenbaum."

You hand finds mine in the pocket of my Loden coat,
Palm to palm, fingers interlocking we turn toward
Home as snow flurries begin to swirl in the cold air.

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At The Villa Monte Gatto

When the sun is hot, I dream
Of afternoons spent in your
Cool dark bedroom in the old
Hotel. You held my face, warm
Against your breasts. Together
We explored the skills that made
Us spellbound secret lovers.

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Beverly Nan McNabb



1932 – 2025

I was born on January 9, 1932, in Spearman, Hansford County, Texas. My parents were Ruth Pauline Prutsman McNabb and Warren Gilbert McNabb. I was born in my McNabb grandparents' home. My parents were living on a farm a few miles out of town.

According to my cousin, Anna Carol Davidson, she was supposed to go to a movie in a nearby town that afternoon but instead got a cousin. She never let me forget it, though she did forget the name of the movie. I became her special person.

My brother, Warren Neil McNabb, was born on January 7, 1934.

This was during the Great Depression of the 1930s. Our younger years were simple. My dad, a World War I veteran, supported his family by being a sign painter and house painter.

In the summers, he would follow the grain harvests, starting in Texas and traveling north—far north one summer to Walden, Colorado. For us kids, those were fun summers. He built a "trailer house" for us to live in. We would travel between small towns and camp along streams.

One memory is of Neil playing with Daddy's .22 rifle when a bee lit on it. Of course, Neil pinched the bee and got stung.

One year we stopped for the apple harvest. Dad picked apples. Any that had fallen on the ground around the picked areas, Mom and us kids could pick up. I can still remember the smell of all those apples we took back to Texas.

We were camped at Eagle Nest Lake, New Mexico, when we got news of my grandfather's death—Walter Scott McNabb—in 1936. I suppose someone knew where we were and they called or wired the sheriff's office, and they found us. We made a quick trip back to Spearman, Texas, and moved in with my grandmother for a few years. Neil and I called her "Mac."

Later, we moved into a house at the other end of the block. Between the houses was just open space, always with tall grass. It was a good place for us and the neighborhood kids to play.

At the back of her house was a big barn full of stuff. There was a big peach tree at one corner, and along the north side of her house was a row of cherry trees—wild sour cherries. She and Mom would can peaches and cherries for winter pies.

After I started school, we took no more summer treks. We continued to live in the same house. Mom always had a large garden.

I remember one Sunday morning Dad went to town, as always, to buy the Sunday Denver Post. He came home with the news that Japan had bombed Pearl Harbor on December 7, 1941. I had no idea what that was about or where it was. Life changed.

I learned to knit in school to make squares for blankets for the war effort.

The next fall, Dad went to work for the Santa Fe Railroad as a sign painter. We moved to Winslow, Arizona. What a change. Everybody in Spearman had the same color skin as mine—pink. I learned quickly that people come in many different colors.

Neil and I had to walk seven blocks to school. Back in Spearman, we only had a block or two. During those early war years, Winslow continued to grow. The Santa Fe Railroad's main cross-country tracks ran through the center of town.

We lived in a motel room for the first year, then moved to a little house, which Dad immediately began remodeling. It was closer to the schools too.

Life in Arizona was hard during World War II. Sugar, butter, and gasoline were rationed. Meat wasn't rationed, but there wasn't much of it. We walked everywhere and carried paper sacks to bring home groceries.

I remember ration books with coupons for sugar, butter, and gasoline. Oleo was a substitute for butter. It was white, like Crisco, and came with a color packet to mix in so it looked like butter. Mom made cakes using syrup instead of sugar.

Trains full of soldiers came through Winslow many times a day. We, and many others, would go down to the train depot to wave at them. The La Posada Hotel and the depot were close together. We could sit on the rock wall around the hotel and wave.

Dad saved his gasoline coupons so that on Sundays we could drive out into the desert or along the Little Colorado River for a picnic. We picked up lots of rocks and pieces of driftwood. Dad made things with the driftwood. He made several lamp stands.

After the war was over in 1945, we would go south of town to Clear Creek to picnic, then farther into the mountains on picnics or camping trips. Chevlon Canyon was a favorite, as well as Sheep's Crossing at the headwaters of the Little Colorado River. McNary is the only nearby town I remember.

I was an above-average student but quiet and shy. I was a baton twirler and a drum majorette in junior high and my freshman year of high school. I was also part of a cheering team of about twenty girls. There was a roller skating rink too.

In 1950, after I graduated from high school, Dad transferred to Albuquerque, New Mexico. He and Mom bought a house on Utah Street. I went to business school for a year, then went to work doing clerical work.

I soon met Wylie Edgar Duke Jr. We married on May 3, 1952. We had three children:
Wylie Paul, born February 16, 1953;
Ellen Lucille, born February 23, 1955;
and Laurie Annette, born September 26, 1957.

The marriage failed after a few years, and the kids and I moved in with my folks on Utah Street for several years. That's when I went to work at Albuquerque National Bank, and after a few years I met another bank employee, Harry Joseph Orr.

Our Life with Harry

by Wylie Paul Duke

When my mother later married Harry Joseph Orr, none of us could have known how much he would change our lives. Looking back now, it's clear that Harry was a godsend for all of us — for my mom, for my two sisters, and especially for me.

As a teenage boy, I needed the influence and guidance of an adult man in my life, though I didn't understand that at the time. I see it very clearly now. Harry gave us stability, structure, and a kind of steady love that never wavered. He always told us — individually and together — that he loved us. He never faltered. That consistency mattered more than I understood then.

Harry was an intelligent man — well read, college educated, and deeply curious about the world. Years after he had passed, I was sharing some of my own interests with my mom — ideas about history, the universe, and other unconventional topics — and she told me Harry had been interested in those same things. He read about them and talked with her about them quietly, without an audience. I wish I had known that then. I wish I had him to talk to even now.

Harry had never been around children before he became part of our family, which makes how he handled it even more remarkable. Somehow, he got it right. He was firm when it mattered and fair always. I remember being punished once in junior high — a couple of hard whacks with a board in the garage. It hurt, and it straightened me out. That was the end of it. There was no cruelty, no lingering fear, and it never happened again. After that, discipline meant grounding or losing privileges. He didn't need to repeat lessons.

We had family dinners at the dining room table every night. That was simply how things were done. After dinner we often played games — Monopoly, gin rummy, and especially cribbage. Harry taught me to play cribbage, and we played a lot. Fifteen-two, fifteen-four, fifteen-six — six is a dozen. I kept my cribbage board on the wall for most of my life. I don't know where it is now, but the habit of counting and thinking stayed with me.

Camping and outdoor life were a big part of our family. We went on countless camping trips and picnics. Several years we went into the mountains to cut our own Christmas tree. We'd picnic first, search for the right tree, cut it down, and tie it to the roof for the ride home. Once, in a two-wheel-drive Dodge van, we got stuck. Harry was mad and did some cussing, but he wouldn't let any of us kids get out of the van while he dug it out. That was the only time I remember us ever getting stuck anywhere.

We also had regular picnics — Easter was often spent up on Sandia Mountain below the ski area. Us kids would run all over the place while Harry and my mom stayed back. Years later, my mom remembered those picnics clearly. After reading her story, I realized why: her own father had taken them camping when she was young. Camping wasn't new to her — Harry brought something back that she already loved.

By the time Harry died, all of us kids were adults and well on our own. It was about twenty years ago now. I can't really remember what the house felt like without him, which tells me how fully he became part of our foundation.

Looking back, I understand something I couldn't see as a boy: Harry didn't save us by doing anything dramatic. He saved us by being steady, fair, and present every day. He showed us what competence, responsibility, and love looked like in practice.

Harry saved us all.

Addendum: Memories of Nan

by Wylie Paul Duke

This booklet was created in memory of Mom and brings together her life story, family history, and the memories shared by those who knew her. It also includes the guest list and a few handwritten memories from the service.



Memories of Beverly Nan Orr

https://pduke.github.io/mcnabb.fanclub.rocks/mcdata/Memories%20of%20Beverly%20Nan%20Orr.pdf

Walter Craig Davidson's Research

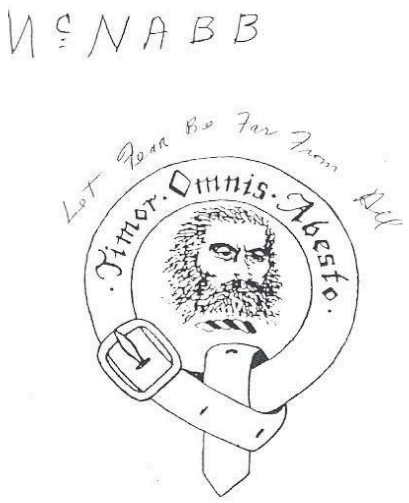


Figure 1: From the opening page of Craig's McNabb chapter

Much of the history preserved in this archive rests on the genealogical research assembled by **Walter Craig Davidson**.

Paul Duke recalls his mother, Beverly Nan McNabb Orr, describing years of research by Craig, including journeys to Scotland in search of church records. Those details come from family recollection; the surviving documents also show his long-standing interest in historical sources and records.

The clan crest carries the motto *Timor Omnis Abesto* — "Let fear be far from all."

How the research reached our family

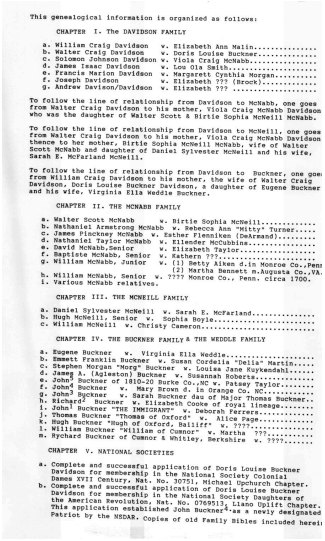
As Paul remembers his mother telling the story, her brother **Warren Neil McNabb** received a copy of Craig's research and later shared it with Nan and their cousin **Jimmy Nagle**. They examined the collection and extended the family history with more recent generations.

Nan eventually assembled her own research notebook and gave copies to her children. Paul used his copy to build the original family website, later working with **Neeve McNabb** to add biographies, photographs and other material.

What Craig collected

The original contents page identifies a research collection substantially broader than the documents now available on this website. It lists five chapters:

1. **The Davidson Family**
2. **The McNabb Family**
3. **The McNeill Family**
4. **The Buckner and Weddle Families**
5. **National Societies** — genealogical applications and supporting records



This genealogical information is organized as follows:

CHAPTER I. The DAVIDSON FAMILY

a. William Craig Davidson w. Elizabeth Ann Malin.....
b. Walter Craig Davidson w. Doris Louise Buckner.....
c. Solomon Johnson Davidson w. Viola Craig McNabb.....
d. James Isaac Davidson w. Lou Ola Smith.....
e. Francis Marion Davidson w. Margarett Cynthia Morgan.....
f. Joseph Davidson w. Elizabeth ??? (Brock).....
g. Andrew Davison/Davidson w. Elizabeth ??? .....

To follow the line of relationship from Davidson to McNabb, one goes from Walter Craig Davidson to his mother, Viola Craig McNabb Davidson who was the daughter of Walter Scott & Birtie Sophia McNeill McNabb.

To follow the line of relationship from Davidson to McNeill, one goes from Walter Craig Davidson to his mother, Viola Craig McNabb Davidson thence to her mother, Birtie Sophia McNeill McNabb, wife of Walter Scott McNabb and daughter of Daniel Sylvester McNeill and his wife, Sarah E. McFarland McNeill.

To follow the line of relationship from Davidson to Buckner, one goes from Willian Craig Davidson to his mother, the wife of Walter Craig Davidson, Doris Louise Buckner Davidson, a daughter of Eugene Buckner and his wife, Virginia Ella Weddle Buckner.

CHAPTER II. THE MCNABB FAMILY

a. Walter Scott McNabb w. Birtie Sophia McNeill.....
b. Nathaniel Armstrong McNabb w. Rebecca Ann "Mitty" Turner.....
c. James Pinckney McNabb w. Esther Flenniken (DeArmand).....
d. Nathaniel Taylor McNabb w. Ellender McCubbins.....
e. David McNabb,Senior w. Elizabeth Taylor.....
f. Baptiste McNabb, Senior w. Kathern ???.....
g. William McNabb, Junior w. (1) Betty Aiken d.in Monroe Co.,Penn
(2) Martha Bennett m.Augusta Co.,VA.
h. William McNabb, Senior w. ???? Monroe Co., Penn. circa 1700.
i. Various McNabb relatives.

CHAPTER III. THE MCNEILL FAMILY

a. Daniel Sylvester McNeill w. Sarah E. McFarland.....
b. Hugh McNeill, Senior w. Sophia Boyle.....
c. William McNeill w. Christy Cameron.....

CHAPTER IV. THE BUCKNER FAMILY & THE WEDDLE FAMILY

a. Eugene Buckner w. Virginia Ella Weddle.....
b. Emmett Franklin Buckner w. Susan Cordalia "Delia" Martin.....
c. Stephen Morgan "Morg" Buckner w. Louisa Jane Kuykendahl.....
d. Jamej A. (Aglaston) Buckner w. Susannah Roberts.....
e. John[3] Buckner of 1810-20 Burke Co.,NC w. Patsey Taylor.....
f. John[4] Buckner w. Mary Brown d. in Orange Co. NC.....
g. John[5] Buckner w. Sarah Buckner dau of Major Thomas Buckner.
h. Richard[6] Buckner w. Elizabeth Cooke of royal lineage.....
i. John[1] Buckner "THE IMMIGRANT" w. Deborah Ferrers.....
j. Thomas Buckner "Thomas of Oxford" w. Alice Page.....
k. Hugh Buckner "Hugh of Oxford, Bailiff" w. ????.....
l. William Buckner "William of Cumnor" w. Martha ???.....
m. Rychard Buckner of Cumnor & Whitley, Berkshire w. ????.....

CHAPTER V. NATIONAL SOCIETIES

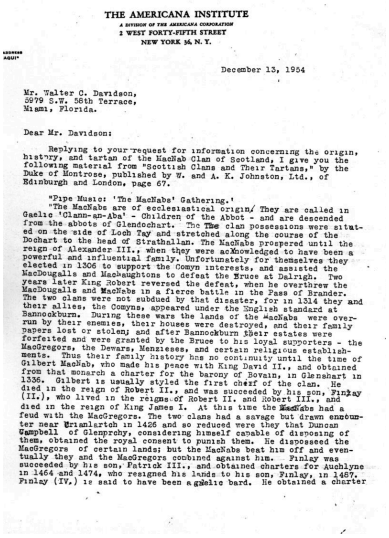
a. Complete and successful application of Doris Louise Buckner Davidson for membership in the National Society Colonial Dames XVII Century, Nat. No. 30751, Michael Upchurch Chapter.
b. Complete and successful application of Doris Louise Buckner Davidson for membership in the National Society Daughters of the American Revolution, Nat. No. 0769513, Llano Uplift Chapter. This application established John Buckner[4] as a newly designated Patriot by the NSDAR. Copies of old Family Bibles included here:

Figure 2: Craig's original contents page, listing all five chapters. The surviving digitized collection principally covers Chapters II and III.

The online search currently covers **277 individually scanned pages**: 247 labeled as McNabb material and 30 as McNeill material. We do not know where the remaining chapters of Craig's research are today.

A glimpse into the documents

The opening pages contain much more than names and dates: clan insignia, historical articles, illustrations and correspondence. A letter dated **December 13, 1954**, addressed to Walter C. Davidson in Miami, answers his inquiry about the MacNab clan's origins, history and tartan.



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2 WEST FORTY-FIFTH STREET
NEW YORK 36, N. Y.

December 13, 1954

Mr. Walter C. Davidson,
5979 S.W. 56th Terrace,
Miami, Florida.

Dear Mr. Davidson:

Replying to your request for information concerning the origin, history, and tartan of the MacNab Clan of Scotland, I give you the following material from "Scottish Clans and Their Tartans," by the Duke of Montrose, published by W. and A. K. Johnston, Ltd., of Edinburgh and London, page 67.

"Pipe Music: 'The MacNabs' Gathering.'

"The MacNabs are of ecclesiastical origin/ They are called in Gaelic 'Clann-an-Aba' - Children of the Abbot - and are descended from the abbots of Glendochart. The The clan possessions were situated on the side of Loch Tay and stretched along the course of the Dochart to the head of Strathallan. The MacNabs prospered until the reign of Alexander III., when they were acknowledged to have been a powerful and influential family. Unfortunately for themselves they elected in 1306 to support the Comyn interests, and assisted the MacDougalls and MacDoughtons to defeat the Bruce at Dalrigh. Two years later King Robert reversed the defeat, when he overthrew the MacDougalls and MacNabs in a fierce battle in the Pass of Brander. The two clans were not subdued by that disaster, for in 1314 they and their allies, the Comyns, appeared under the English standard at Bannockburn. During these wars the lands of the MacNabs were overrun by their enemies, their houses were destroyed, and their family papers lost or stolen; and after Bannockburn their estates were forfeited and were granted by the Bruce to his loyal supporters - the MacGregors, the Devars, Menzieses, and certain religious establishments. Thus their family history has no continuity until the time of Gilbert MacNab, who made his peace with King David II., and obtained from that monarch a charter for the barony of Bovain, in Glenshart in 1336. Gilbert is usually styled the first chief of the clan. He died in the reign of Robert II., and was succeeded by his son, Finlay (II.), who lived in the reigns of Robert II. and Robert III., and died in the reign of King James I. At this time the MacNabs had a feud with the MacGregors. The two clans had a savage but drawn encounter near Kinlarth in 1426 and so reduced were they that Duncan Campbell of Glenorchy, considering himself capable of dispersing of them, obtained the royal consent to punish them. He dispossed the MacGregors of certain lands; but the MacNabs beat him off and eventually they and the MacGregors combined against him. Finlay was succeeded by his son, Patrick III., and obtained charters for Auchlyne in 1464 and 1474, who resigned his lands to his son, Finlay, in 1487. Finlay (IV.) is said to have been a Gaelic bard. He obtained a charter

Figure 3: The 1954 letter from the Americana Institute (scanned research page 3)



468 SCOTTISH BORE BRIEVES.

Figure 4: Historical MacNab arms from the research collection (page 11)

A historical map places many of the clan landmarks around **Killin, Loch Tay and Glen Dochart in Perthshire, Scotland**. Below is a drawing of the old clan burial ground on Inchbuie.

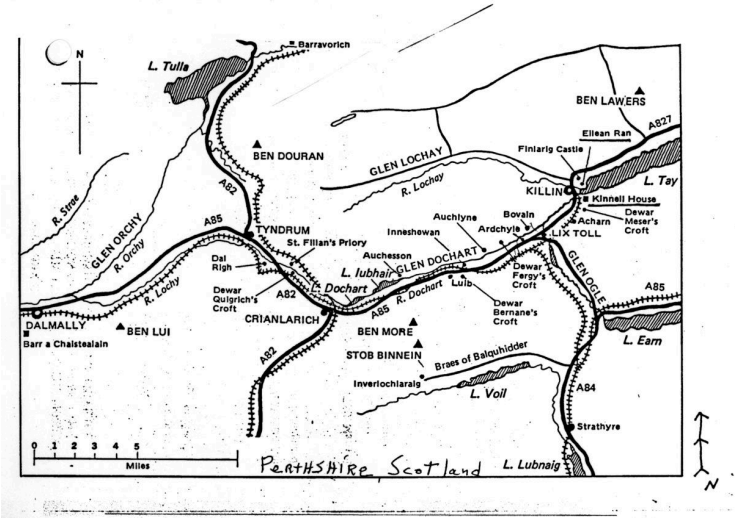


Figure 5: The historic map reproduced in Craig's collection (page 15)



Figure 6: Illustration of the MacNab clan burial ground at Inchbuie (page 15)

These pages include older historical accounts collected by Craig; they are not all Craig's own writing. The scans preserve the original material, while OCR text makes it searchable but can contain transcription errors.

Explore the complete surviving collection

Search the recognized text, inspect a page, then open the matching original scan if the OCR is unclear.

Search the 277 scanned pages

Search Craig's Original Research

https://pduke.github.io/mcnabb.fanclub.rocks/mchtml/ocr_text.html

Can you help locate the missing research?

Craig also researched other branches of the family. If additional notebooks or research documents survive among relatives, we would be interested in hearing about them. **Neeve McNabb** welcomes family stories, photographs, corrections, and additional research. You can contact her through her Facebook profile.

Contact Neeve McNabb on Facebook

https://www.facebook.com/neeve.Valenzuela

About This Archive

The McNabb Family Archive began with family records collected by Beverly Nan McNabb and genealogical research preserved by Walter Craig Davidson. Over time, these materials grew into a website containing family histories, photographs, documents, and other records. Eventually, with encouragement and substantial contributions from Neeve McNabb, the idea of a printed book took shape.

Both the website and the book were developed using modern, freely available tools. The website is maintained through GitHub, where the project files and their revision history can be preserved and shared. The book itself was typeset using Typst, a programmable publishing system that allows the same source material to produce different editions. ChatGPT was used to expedite the writing of the Typst code for the book's PDF editions, the HTML code for the accompanying website, and the creation of several illustrations.

Neeve McNabb contributed family research, historical material, additional content, careful proofreading, and thoughtful observations throughout the book's development. Her contributions helped make the collection more complete and accurate.

The intention is to make the archive an open-source project. The website is already available online, and the book's source files are intended to join it on GitHub. Future family members—or anyone with an interest in the history—will be welcome to study the material, correct errors, add discoveries, and continue the work, subject to the rights of the original contributors and creators.

The hope is that someday someone will take this project and run with it. There are undoubtedly more stories to uncover, more photographs to identify, and more branches of the family to explore.

Compiled by



Paul Duke



Neeve McNabb

About This Archive

A collection of family biographies, photographs, poems, and records gathered and preserved for the McNabb family. This archive traces family history from 1702 to 2025 and brings together the stories of James Pinckney McNabb, Walter Scott McNabb, Warren Gilbert McNabb, Ruth Pauline Prutsman, Warren Neil McNabb, Beverly Nan McNabb, and related family history materials.

Prepared as a family keepsake and reference, this volume preserves memories, images, and written records for future generations.



Compiled by Paul Duke and Neeve McNabb

https://pduke.github.io/mcnabb.fanclub.rocks/